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United States Patent Application Publication

20250285514

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 11, 2025

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SYSTEM AND METHOD FOR SLOT MACHINE GAME ASSOCIATED WITH MARKET LINE WAGERS

Abstract

System and methods related to wagering, such as slot machines and/or other electronic games. Some wagering may relate to market indicators, market lines, and/or stop commands.

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Family ID: 1000008621121

Appl. No.: 19/215634

Filed: May 22, 2025

Related U.S. Application Data

parent US continuation 18527620 20231204 parent-grant-document US 12347282 child US 19215634

parent US continuation 17358136 20210625 parent-grant-document US 11875651 child US 18527620

parent US continuation 16662415 20191024 parent-grant-document US 11049369 child US 17358136

parent US continuation 14311917 20140623 parent-grant-document US 10482721 child US 16662415

parent US continuation 11963158 20071221 parent-grant-document US 8758108 child US 14311917

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G07F17/34 (20060101); G07F17/32 (20060101)

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/527,620 filed Dec. 4, 2023, which is a continuation of U.S. Patent Application No. 17/358, 136 filed Jun. 25, 2021 (now U.S. Pat. No. 11,875,651 issued Jan. 16, 2024), which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/662,415 filed Oct. 24, 2019 (now U.S. Pat. No. 11,049,369 issued Jun. 29, 2021), which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/311,917 filed Jun. 23, 2014 (now U.S. Pat. No. 10,482,721 issued Nov. 19, 2019), which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 11/963,158 filed Dec. 21, 2007 (now U.S. Pat. No. 8,758,108 issued Jun. 24, 2014), each of which is incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0002] FIG. 1 illustrates an example system for wagering based on financial market indicators in accordance with an embodiment of the present invention;

[0003] FIG. 2 illustrates one embodiment of a slot machine used with the system of FIG. 1;

[0004] FIG. 3 illustrates a flowchart depicting one example method for wagering based on financial market indicators;

[0005] FIG. 4 illustrates another embodiment of a slot machine used with the system of FIG. 1;

[0006] FIG. 5 illustrates a flowchart depicting another example method for wagering based on financial market indicators;

[0007] FIG. 6 illustrates a client that provides a slot machine game that comprises one or more stop buttons associated with financial market indicators, according to certain embodiments;

[0008] FIG. 7 illustrates a client that provides a slot machine game in which one or more stop buttons correspond to reels that spin independently of financial market indicators, according to certain embodiments;

[0009] FIG. 8 illustrates a method for a slot machine game that is associated with financial market indicators and that includes one or more stop buttons, according to certain embodiments;

[0010] FIG. 9 illustrates a client that provides wagering opportunities associated with moving market indicators, according to certain embodiments;

[0011] FIG. 10 illustrates a client that provides a slot machine game that is generally associated with market line wagers, according to certain embodiments; and

[0012] FIG. 11 illustrates a flowchart for managing a slot machine game associated with market line wagers, according to certain embodiments.

Description

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EXAMPLE EMBODIMENTS OF THE INVENTION

[0013] The following sections I-X provide a guide to interpreting the present application.

I. Terms

[0014] The term “product” means any machine, manufacture and/or composition of matter, unless expressly specified otherwise.

[0015] The term “process” means any process, algorithm, method, or the like, unless expressly specified otherwise.

[0016] Each process (whether called a method, algorithm or otherwise) inherently includes one or

more steps, and therefore all references to a “step” or “steps” of a process have an inherent antecedent basis in the mere recitation of the term ‘process’ or a like term. Accordingly, any reference in a claim to a ‘step’ or ‘steps’ of a process has sufficient antecedent basis.

[0017] The term “invention” and the like mean “the one or more inventions disclosed in this application”, unless expressly specified otherwise.

[0018] The terms “an embodiment”, “embodiment”, “embodiments”, “the embodiment”, “the embodiments”, “one or more embodiments”, “some embodiments”, “certain embodiments”, “one embodiment”, “another embodiment” and the like mean “one or more (but not all) embodiments of the disclosed invention(s)”, unless expressly specified otherwise.

[0019] The term “variation” of an invention means an embodiment of the invention, unless expressly specified otherwise.

[0020] A reference to “another embodiment” in describing an embodiment does not imply that the referenced embodiment is mutually exclusive with another embodiment (e.g., an embodiment described before the referenced embodiment), unless expressly specified otherwise.

[0021] The terms “including”, “comprising” and variations thereof mean “including but not limited to”, unless expressly specified otherwise.

[0022] The terms “a”, “an” and “the” mean “one or more”, unless expressly specified otherwise.

[0023] The term “plurality” means “two or more”, unless expressly specified otherwise.

[0024] The term “herein” means “in the present application, including anything which may be incorporated by reference”, unless expressly specified otherwise.

[0025] The phrase “at least one of”, when such phrase modifies a plurality of things (such as an enumerated list of things) means any combination of one or more of those things, unless expressly specified otherwise. For example, the phrase “at least one of a widget, a car and a wheel” means either (i) a widget, (ii) a car, (iii) a wheel, (iv) a widget and a car, (v) a widget and a wheel, (vi) a car and a wheel, or (vii) a widget, a car, and a wheel. The phrase “at least one of”, when such phrase modifies a plurality of things does not mean “one of each of” the plurality of things.

[0026] Numerical terms such as “one”, “two”, etc. when used as cardinal numbers to indicate quantity of something (e.g., one widget, two widgets), mean the quantity indicated by that numerical term, but do not mean at least the quantity indicated by that numerical term. For example, the phrase “one widget” does not mean “at least one widget”, and therefore the phrase “one widget” does not cover, e.g., two widgets.

[0027] The phrase “based on” does not mean “based only on”, unless expressly specified otherwise. In other words, the phrase “based on” describes both “based only on” and “based at least on”. The phrase “based at least on” is equivalent to the phrase “based at least in part on”.

[0028] The term “represent” and like terms are not exclusive, unless expressly specified otherwise. For example, the term “represents” do not mean “represents only”, unless expressly specified otherwise. In other words, the phrase “the data represents a credit card number” describes both “the data represents only a credit card number” and “the data represents a credit card number, and the data also represents something else”.

[0029] The term “whereby” is used herein only to precede a clause or other set of words that express only the intended result, objective, or consequence of something that is previously and explicitly recited. Thus, when the term “whereby” is used in a claim, the clause, or other words that the term “whereby” modifies do not establish specific further limitations of the claim or otherwise restricts the meaning or scope of the claim.

[0030] The term “e.g.” and like terms mean “for example”, and thus does not limit the term or phrase it explains. For example, in the sentence “the computer sends data (e.g., instructions, a data structure) over the Internet”, the term “e.g.” explains that “instructions” are an example of “data” that the computer may send over the Internet, and also explains that “a data structure” is an example of “data” that the computer may send over the Internet. However, both “instructions” and “a data structure” are merely examples of “data”, and other things besides “instructions” and “a

data structure” can be “data”.

[0031] The term “respective” and like terms mean “taken individually”. Thus if two or more things have “respective” characteristics, then each such thing has its own characteristic, and these characteristics can be different from each other but need not be. For example, the phrase “each of two machines has a respective function” means that the first such machine has a function and the second such machine has a function as well. The function of the first machine may or may not be the same as the function of the second machine.

[0032] The term “i.e.” and like terms mean “that is”, and thus limits the term or phrase it explains. For example, in the sentence “the computer sends data (i.e., instructions) over the Internet”, the term “i.e.” explains that “instructions” are the “data” that the computer sends over the Internet.

[0033] Any given numerical range shall include whole and fractions of numbers within the range. For example, the range “1 to 10” shall be interpreted to specifically include whole numbers between 1 and 10 (e.g., 1, 2, 3, 4, . . . 9) and non-whole numbers (e.g., 1.1, 1.2, . . . 1.9).

[0034] Where two or more terms or phrases are synonymous (e.g., because of an explicit statement that the terms or phrases are synonymous), instances of one such term/phrase does not mean instances of another such term/phrase must have a different meaning. For example, where a statement renders the meaning of “including” to be synonymous with “including but not limited to”, the mere usage of the phrase “including but not limited to” does not mean that the term “including” means something other than “including but not limited to”.

[0035] The term “facilitating” and like terms may include any action or set of actions which help to bring about a result. Throughout this disclosure, examples of facilitation may be given. Such examples should be interpreted as non-limiting examples only.

II. Determining

[0036] The term “determining” and grammatical variants thereof (e.g., to determine a price, determining a value, determine an object which meets a certain criterion) is used in an extremely broad sense. The term “determining” encompasses a wide variety of actions and therefore “determining” can include calculating, computing, processing, deriving, investigating, looking up (e.g., looking up in a table, a database, or another data structure), ascertaining and the like. Also, “determining” can include receiving (e.g., receiving information), accessing (e.g., accessing data in a memory) and the like. Also, “determining” can include resolving, selecting, choosing, establishing, and the like.

[0037] The term “determining” does not imply certainty or absolute precision, and therefore “determining” can include estimating, extrapolating, predicting, guessing and the like.

[0038] The term “determining” does not imply that mathematical processing must be performed and does not imply that numerical methods must be used and does not imply that an algorithm or process is used.

[0039] The term “determining” does not imply that any particular device must be used. For example, a computer need not necessarily perform the determining.

III. Forms of Sentences

[0040] Where a limitation of a first claim would cover one of a feature as well as more than one of a feature (e.g., a limitation such as “at least one widget” covers one widget as well as more than one widget), and where in a second claim that depends on the first claim, the second claim uses a definite article “the” to refer to the limitation (e.g., “the widget”), this does not imply that the first claim covers only one of the feature, and this does not imply that the second claim covers only one of the feature (e.g., “the widget” can cover both one widget and more than one widget).

[0041] When an ordinal number (such as “first”, “second”, “third” and so on) is used as an adjective before a term, that ordinal number is used (unless expressly specified otherwise) merely to indicate a particular feature, such as to distinguish that particular feature from another feature that is described by the same term or by a similar term. For example, a “first widget” may be so named merely to distinguish it from, e.g., a “second widget”. Thus, the mere usage of the ordinal

numbers “first” and “second” before the term “widget” does not indicate any other relationship between the two widgets, and likewise does not indicate any other characteristics of either or both widgets. For example, the mere usage of the ordinal numbers “first” and “second” before the term “widget” (1) does not indicate that either widget comes before or after any other in order or location; (2) does not indicate that either widget occurs or acts before or after any other in time; and (3) does not indicate that either widget ranks above or below any other, as in importance or quality. In addition, the mere usage of ordinal numbers does not define a numerical limit to the features identified with the ordinal numbers. For example, the mere usage of the ordinal numbers “first” and “second” before the term “widget” does not indicate that there must be no more than two widgets.

[0042] When a single device, article or other product is described herein, more than one device/article (whether or not they cooperate) may alternatively be used in place of the single device/article that is described. Accordingly, the functionality that is described as being possessed by a device may alternatively be possessed by more than one device/article (whether or not they cooperate).

[0043] Similarly, where more than one device, article or other product is described herein (whether or not they cooperate), a single device/article may alternatively be used in place of the more than one device or article that is described. For example, a plurality of computer-based devices may be substituted with a single computer-based device. Accordingly, the various functionality that is described as being possessed by more than one device or article may alternatively be possessed by a single device/article.

[0044] The functionality and/or the features of a single device that is described may be alternatively embodied by one or more other devices which are described but are not explicitly described as having such functionality/features. Thus, other embodiments need not include the described device itself, but rather can include the one or more other devices which would, in those other embodiments, have such functionality/features.

IV. Disclosed Examples and Terminology Are Not Limiting

[0045] Neither the Title (set forth at the beginning of the first page of the present application) nor the Abstract (set forth at the end of the present application) is to be taken as limiting in any way as the scope of the disclosed invention(s). An Abstract has been included in this application merely because an Abstract of not more than 150 words is required under 37 C.F.R. § 1.72(b).

[0046] The title of the present application and headings of sections provided in the present application are for convenience only and are not to be taken as limiting the disclosure in any way.

[0047] Numerous embodiments are described in the present application and are presented for illustrative purposes only. The described embodiments are not, and are not intended to be, limiting in any sense. The presently disclosed invention(s) are widely applicable to numerous embodiments, as is readily apparent from the disclosure. One of ordinary skill in the art will recognize that the disclosed invention(s) may be practiced with various modifications and alterations, such as structural, logical, software, and electrical modifications. Although particular features of the disclosed invention(s) may be described with reference to one or more particular embodiments and/or drawings, it should be understood that such features are not limited to usage in the one or more particular embodiments or drawings with reference to which they are described, unless expressly specified otherwise.

[0048] No embodiment of method steps or product elements described in the present application constitutes the invention claimed herein, or is essential to the invention claimed herein, or is coextensive with the invention claimed herein, except where it is either expressly stated to be so in this specification or expressly recited in a claim.

[0049] The preambles of the claims that follow recite purposes, benefits, and possible uses of the claimed invention only and do not limit the claimed invention.

[0050] The present disclosure is not a literal description of all embodiments of the invention(s). Also, the present disclosure is not a listing of features of the invention(s) which must be present in

all embodiments.

[0051] Devices that are described as in communication with each other need not be in continuous communication with each other, unless expressly specified otherwise. On the contrary, such devices need only transmit to each other as necessary or desirable and may actually refrain from exchanging data most of the time. For example, a machine in communication with another machine via the Internet may not transmit data to the other machine for long period of time (e.g. weeks at a time). In addition, devices that are in communication with each other may communicate directly or indirectly through one or more intermediaries.

[0052] A description of an embodiment with several components or features does not imply that all or even any of such components/features are required. On the contrary, a variety of optional components are described to illustrate the wide variety of possible embodiments of the present invention(s). Unless otherwise specified explicitly, no component/feature is essential or required.

[0053] Although process steps, algorithms or the like may be described or claimed in a particular sequential order, such processes may be configured to work in different orders. In other words, any sequence or order of steps that may be explicitly described or claimed does not necessarily indicate a requirement that the steps be performed in that order. The steps of processes described herein may be performed in any order possible. Further, some steps may be performed simultaneously despite being described or implied as occurring non-simultaneously (e.g., because one step is described after the other step). Moreover, the illustration of a process by its depiction in a drawing does not imply that the illustrated process is exclusive of other variations and modifications thereto, does not imply that the illustrated process or any of its steps are necessary to the invention(s), and does not imply that the illustrated process is preferred.

[0054] Although a process may be described as including a plurality of steps, that does not imply that all or any of the steps are preferred, essential or required. Various other embodiments within the scope of the described invention(s) include other processes that omit some or all of the described steps. Unless otherwise specified explicitly, no step is essential or required.

[0055] Although a process may be described singly or without reference to other products or methods, in an embodiment the process may interact with other products or methods. For example, such interaction may include linking one business model to another business model. Such interaction may be provided to enhance the flexibility or desirability of the process.

[0056] Although a product may be described as including a plurality of components, aspects, qualities, characteristics and/or features, that does not indicate that any or all of the plurality are preferred, essential or required. Various other embodiments within the scope of the described invention(s) include other products that omit some or all of the described plurality.

[0057] An enumerated list of items (which may or may not be numbered) does not imply that any or all of the items are mutually exclusive, unless expressly specified otherwise. Likewise, an enumerated list of items (which may or may not be numbered) does not imply that any or all of the items are comprehensive of any category, unless expressly specified otherwise. For example, the enumerated list “a computer, a laptop, a PDA” does not imply that any or all of the three items of that list are mutually exclusive and does not imply that any or all of the three items of that list are comprehensive of any category.

[0058] An enumerated list of items (which may or may not be numbered) does not imply that any or all of the items are equivalent to each other or readily substituted for each other.

[0059] All embodiments are illustrative, and do not imply that the invention or any embodiments were made or performed, as the case may be.

V. Computing

[0060] It will be readily apparent to one of ordinary skill in the art that the various processes described herein may be implemented by, e.g., appropriately programmed general purpose computers, special purpose computers and computing devices. One or more such computers or computing devices may be referred to as a computer system. The computer system may comprise a

plurality of server computers and client computers. Typically a processor (e.g., one or more microprocessors, one or more microcontrollers, one or more digital signal processors) will receive instructions (e.g., from a memory or like device), and execute those instructions, thereby performing one or more processes defined by those instructions. Instructions may be embodied in, e.g., one or more computer programs, one or more scripts.

[0061] A “processor” means one or more microprocessors, central processing units (CPUs), computing devices, microcontrollers, digital signal processors, or like devices or any combination thereof, regardless of the architecture (e.g., chip-level multiprocessing/multi-core, RISC, CISC, Microprocessor without Interlocked Pipeline Stages, pipelining configuration, simultaneous multithreading).

[0062] Thus a description of a process is likewise a description of an apparatus for performing the process. The apparatus that performs the process can include, e.g., a processor and those input devices and output devices that are appropriate to perform the process.

[0063] Further, programs that implement such methods (as well as other types of data) may be stored and transmitted using a variety of media (e.g., computer readable media) in a number of manners. In some embodiments, hard-wired circuitry or custom hardware may be used in place of, or in combination with, some or all of the software instructions that can implement the processes of various embodiments. Thus, various combinations of hardware and software may be used instead of software only.

[0064] The term “computer-readable medium” refers to any medium, a plurality of the same, or a combination of different media, which participate in providing data (e.g., instructions, data structures) which may be read by a computer, a processor or a like device. Such a medium may take many forms, including but not limited to, non-volatile media, volatile media, and transmission media. Non-volatile media include, for example, optical or magnetic disks and other persistent memory. Volatile media include dynamic random access memory (DRAM), which typically constitutes the main memory. Transmission media include coaxial cables, copper wire and fiber optics, including the wires that comprise a system bus coupled to the processor. Transmission media may include or convey acoustic waves, light waves, and electromagnetic emissions, such as those generated during radio frequency (RF) and infrared (IR) data communications. Common forms of computer-readable media include, for example, a floppy disk, a flexible disk, hard disk, magnetic tape, any other magnetic medium, a CD-ROM, DVD, any other optical medium, punch cards, paper tape, any other physical medium with patterns of holes, a RAM, a PROM, an EPROM, a FLASH-EEPROM, any other memory chip or cartridge, a carrier wave as described hereinafter, or any other medium from which a computer can read.

[0065] Various forms of computer readable media may be involved in carrying data (e.g. sequences of instructions) to a processor. For example, data may be (i) delivered from RAM to a processor; (ii) carried over a wireless transmission medium; (iii) formatted and/or transmitted according to numerous formats, standards or protocols, such as Ethernet (or IEEE 802.3), SAP, ATP, Bluetooth□, and TCP/IP, TDMA, CDMA, and 3G; and/or (iv) encrypted to ensure privacy or prevent fraud in any of a variety of ways well known in the art.

[0066] Thus a description of a process is likewise a description of a computer-readable medium storing a program for performing the process. The computer-readable medium can store (in any appropriate format) those program elements which are appropriate to perform the method.

[0067] Just as the description of various steps in a process does not indicate that all the described steps are required, embodiments of an apparatus include a computer/computing device operable to perform some (but not necessarily all) of the described process.

[0068] Likewise, just as the description of various steps in a process does not indicate that all the described steps are required, embodiments of a computer-readable medium storing a program or data structure include a computer-readable medium storing a program that, when executed, can cause a processor to perform some (but not necessarily all) of the described process.

[0069] A computer system may also include one or more input/output devices. Such input/output devices may include monitors, keyboards, mice, and/or any other desired devices.

[0070] Some computer systems may include transmission medium, which may be referred to as a communication network, that couples various internal components of the computer system. Such a communication network may also be referred to in some implementations as a computer bus. Some computer systems may include a specialized input/output device configured to connect to an external communication network. Such a device may be referred to as a network interface. The external communication network may include a LAN and/or the Internet. In some implementations, an edge routing device may operate between a LAN and another network like the Internet. Such a device may include a firewall and/or any other desired security mechanism.

[0071] Where databases are described, it will be understood by one of ordinary skill in the art that (i) alternative database structures to those described may be readily employed, and (ii) other memory structures besides databases may be readily employed. Any illustrations or descriptions of any sample databases presented herein are illustrative arrangements for stored representations of information. Any number of other arrangements may be employed besides those suggested by, e.g., tables illustrated in drawings or elsewhere. Similarly, any illustrated entries of the databases represent exemplary information only; one of ordinary skill in the art will understand that the number and content of the entries can be different from those described herein. Further, despite any depiction of the databases as tables, other formats (including relational databases, object-based models and/or distributed databases) could be used to store and manipulate the data types described herein. Likewise, object methods or behaviors of a database can be used to implement various processes, such as the described herein. In addition, the databases may, in a known manner, be stored locally or remotely from a device which accesses data in such a database.

[0072] Various embodiments can be configured to work in a network environment including a computer that is in communication (e.g., via a communications network) with one or more devices. The computer may communicate with the devices directly or indirectly, via any wired or wireless medium (e.g. the Internet, LAN, WAN or Ethernet, Token Ring, a telephone line, a cable line, a radio channel, an optical communications line, commercial on-line service providers, bulletin board systems, a satellite communications link, a combination of any of the above). Each of the devices may themselves comprise computers or other computing devices, such as those based on the Intel® Pentium®, Core, or Centrino™ processor, that are adapted to communicate with the computer. Any number and type of devices may be in communication with the computer.

[0073] In an embodiment, a server computer or centralized authority may not be necessary or desirable. For example, the present invention may, in an embodiment, be practiced on one or more devices without a central authority. In such an embodiment, any functions described herein as performed by the server computer or data described as stored on the server computer may instead be performed by or stored on one or more such devices.

[0074] Where a process is described, in an embodiment the process may operate without any user intervention. In another embodiment, the process includes some human intervention (e.g., a step is performed by or with the assistance of a human).

VI. Continuing Applications

[0075] The present disclosure provides, to one of ordinary skill in the art, an enabling description of several embodiments and/or inventions. Some of these embodiments and/or inventions may not be claimed in the present application but may nevertheless be claimed in one or more continuing applications that claim the benefit of priority of the present application.

[0076] Applicants intend to file additional applications to pursue patents for subject matter that has been disclosed and enabled but not claimed in the present application.

VII. 35 U.S.C. § 112, Paragraph 6

[0077] In a claim, a limitation of the claim which includes the phrase “means for” or the phrase “step for” means that 35 U.S.C. § 112, paragraph 6, applies to that limitation.

[0078] In a claim, a limitation of the claim which does not include the phrase “means for” or the phrase “step for” means that 35 U.S.C. § 112, paragraph 6 does not apply to that limitation, regardless of whether that limitation recites a function without recitation of structure, material or acts for performing that function. For example, in a claim, the mere use of the phrase “step of” or the phrase “steps of” in referring to one or more steps of the claim or of another claim does not mean that 35 U.S.C. § 112, paragraph 6, applies to that step(s).

[0079] With respect to a means or a step for performing a specified function in accordance with 35 U.S.C. § 112, paragraph 6, the corresponding structure, material, or acts described in the specification, and equivalents thereof, may perform additional functions as well as the specified function.

[0080] Computers, processors, computing devices and like products are structures that can perform a wide variety of functions. Such products can be operable to perform a specified function by executing one or more programs, such as a program stored in a memory device of that product or in a memory device which that product accesses. Unless expressly specified otherwise, such a program need not be based on any particular algorithm, such as any particular algorithm that might be disclosed in the present application. It is well known to one of ordinary skill in the art that a specified function may be implemented via different algorithms, and any of a number of different algorithms would be a mere design choice for carrying out the specified function.

[0081] Therefore, with respect to a means or a step for performing a specified function in accordance with 35 U.S.C. § 112, paragraph 6, structure corresponding to a specified function includes any product programmed to perform the specified function. Such structure includes programmed products which perform the function, regardless of whether such product is programmed with (i) a disclosed algorithm for performing the function, (ii) an algorithm that is similar to a disclosed algorithm, or (iii) a different algorithm for performing the function.

[0082] Where there is recited a means for performing a function that is a method, one structure for performing this method includes a computing device (e.g., a general purpose computer) that is programmed and/or configured with appropriate hardware to perform that function.

[0083] Also includes a computing device (e.g., a general purpose computer) that is programmed and/or configured with appropriate hardware to perform that function via other algorithms as would be understood by one of ordinary skill in the art.

VIII. Disclaimer

[0084] Numerous references to a particular embodiment does not indicate a disclaimer or disavowal of additional, different embodiments, and similarly references to the description of embodiments which all include a particular feature does not indicate a disclaimer or disavowal of embodiments which do not include that particular feature. A clear disclaimer or disavowal in the present application shall be prefaced by the phrase “does not include” or by the phrase “cannot perform”.

IX. Incorporation By Reference

[0085] Any patent, patent application or other document referred to herein is incorporated by reference into this patent application as part of the present disclosure, but only for purposes of written description in accordance with 35 U.S.C. § 112, paragraph 1 and enablement in accordance with 35 U.S.C. § 112, paragraph 1, and should in no way be used to limit, define, or otherwise construe any term of the present application where the present application, without such incorporation by reference, would not have failed to provide an ascertainable meaning, but rather would have allowed an ascertainable meaning for such term to be provided. Thus, the person of ordinary skill in the art need not have been in any way limited by any embodiments provided in the reference.

[0086] Any incorporation by reference does not, in and of itself, imply any endorsement of, ratification of, or acquiescence in any statements, opinions, arguments or characterizations contained in any incorporated patent, patent application or other document, unless explicitly

specified otherwise in this patent application.

X. Prosecution History

[0087] In interpreting the present application (which includes the claims), one of ordinary skill in the art shall refer to the prosecution history of the present application, but not to the prosecution history of any other patent or patent application, regardless of whether there are other patent applications that are considered related to the present application, and regardless of whether there are other patent applications that share a claim of priority with the present application.

XI. Sample Embodiments

[0088] Some embodiments of this invention relate generally to gaming systems and methods and, more particularly, to systems and methods for wagering based on one or more financial market indicators.

[0089] The rules for playing slot machines can be relatively simple. Generally, a player deposits money and spins the reels. In a physical casino, the player may spin the reels by either pushing a button or yanking on a lever. Reels may spin in any orientation, vertically, horizontally, diagonally, etc. Reels may include virtual or physical embodiments. In an online casino, the player may use a mouse or any suitable computer key to click on the button or lever. A slot machine may have one or more horizontal lines, or paylines, across the window of the slot machine. Such lines, in other embodiments, may be vertical, diagonal, or distributed in a non-line environment, but nonetheless referred to as a line. If a certain combination of symbols falls on a horizontal line when the reels stop, the player may be a winner. Payouts vary by machine and by the number of lines the player chooses to play.

[0090] In some slot machines, the combination of symbols that line up on the reels of a slot machine is determined by a Random Number Generator (RNG). This may include a computer program inside the machine that is used to generate a sequence of numbers in milliseconds. Each random number it generates corresponds to a reel combination. Even when a slot machine is not being used, some RNGs keep doing their job of generating numbers. Whatever random number was generated, the split second the player pulled the handle (or hit the “bet one” or “max bet” button) may result in the corresponding reel combinations that appear on the screen. The RNG may not be affected by how much was bet, whether the player pulled the handle or hit the spin button, whether it is the player's first play or last, whether the player is winning or losing, or whether the player is playing with or without a slot card. It just continually generates random numbers. If the player happens to be the lucky player that plays the split second the RNG generates a number corresponding to a jackpot reel combination, the player may be a winner.

[0091] In one embodiment, a system comprises a memory operable to store a wager regarding a slot machine game. The system may further comprise a processor coupled to the memory and operable to cause a user interface to display a value of a first financial market indicator. The processor may be further operable to update the displayed value of the first financial market indicator at a predetermined rate. The processor may be further operable to receive a first stop command at a first time. In response to receiving the first stop command, the processor may be further operable to determine a first digit from the displayed value of the first financial market indicator at the first time. The processor may be further operable to determine a second digit from a value of a second financial market indicator. The processor may be further operable to determine an outcome of the wager based at least in part on the determined first digit and the determined second digit.

[0092] In another embodiment, a system comprises a memory operable to store an over-under wager associated with a financial market indicator, wherein the over-under wager defines a market line. The system may further comprise a processor coupled to the memory and operable to receive a slot game bet. The processor may be further operable to cause at least one slot reel to stop spinning such that at least one digit is visible on the at least one slot reel. The processor may be further operable to compare the at least one digit with the market line defined by the over-under

wager. The processor may be further operable to determine an outcome of the slot game bet based at least in part on the comparison.

[0093] According to certain embodiments, a system comprises a memory operable to store a wager regarding a slot machine game. The system may further comprise a processor coupled to the memory and operable to cause a user interface to display a value of a first financial market indicator, wherein the displayed value is updated at a predetermined rate. The processor may be further operable to cause the user interface to display a reel that is spinning. The processor may be further operable to receive a first stop command at a first time. In response to receiving the first stop command, the processor may be further operable to determine a first digit from the displayed value of the first financial market indicator at the first time, stop the displayed reel from spinning, and determine a second digit that is visible on the stopped reel, wherein the determined second digit is displayed at a payline. The processor may be further operable to determine an outcome of the wager based at least in part on the determined first digit and the determined second digit.

[0094] In some embodiments, a method for wagering is provided. An example method starts by receiving a bet indicating the value of a multi-digit number. The method continues by determining a first value based at least in part upon the value of a digit of a first financial market indicator, and by determining a second value based at least in part upon the value of a digit of a second financial market indicator. The method proceeds by determining a winning number based at least in part upon the first value and the second value. The method concludes by comparing the winning number against the value of the multi-digit number indicated by the bet, and by determining an outcome of the bet based at least in part upon the comparison.

[0095] In other embodiments, another example method for wagering may be provided. The method starts by receiving a bet regarding a spin of the reels of a slot machine. The method continues by determining a first symbol for a first reel of the slot machine based at least in part upon a first value and a second value. The first value is associated with a value of a digit of a first financial market indicator at a first point in time, and the second value is associated with the value of a digit of a second financial market indicator at the first point in time. The method continues by determining a second symbol for a second reel of the slot machine, and by determining a third symbol for a third reel of the slot machine. The method concludes by determining an outcome of the bet based at least in part upon the first symbol, the second symbol, and the third symbol.

[0096] Various embodiments may benefit from numerous advantages. It should be noted that one or more embodiments may benefit from some, none, or all of the advantages discussed below. One advantage is that a gaming system may provide bettors with gaming based upon the value of financial market indicators. Thus, a bettor may place a bet, such as a bet regarding the spin of the reels of a slot machine, in which the inputs for the game are determined based on the value of financial market indicators rather than the numbers generated by a Random Number Generator. Another advantage is that when financial market indicators are unavailable, such as on the weekends and holidays when financial markets are typically closed, the system determines inputs for the game based on some other type of non-random but unpredictable event.

[0097] Another advantage is that, in some embodiments, the system may provide a slot machine game in which financial market indicators are associated with one or more stop controls (e.g., buttons, etc.). By allowing a user to use stop buttons, the system may give the user the perception that the user's skill or reaction time may affect the outcome of the game. In some embodiments, this perception may be illusory such as, for example, where the values of financial market indicators are updated at a rate that is faster than the typical human reaction time. Nevertheless, this perception may enhance the user's enjoyment of the game.

[0098] Another advantage is that, in some embodiments, the system may provide wagers on moving market lines. For example, the system may provide a fixed-odds wager that a financial market indicator will be above or below a defined market line after a configurable period of time. While a user that has placed such a wager waits for the outcome of the wager, the system may

permit the user to play a slot machine game that is based at least in part on the defined market line. Thus, the system may increase the wagering opportunities available to a user.

[0099] Other advantages may be apparent to one skilled in the art from the description and the appended claims.

[0100] FIG. 1 illustrates one embodiment of a system **10** that includes clients **20** coupled to a controller **40** using communication network **30**. Controller **40** is further coupled to one or more data sources **60** using communication network **50**. In general, system **10** provides for wagering based at least in part upon event information **64**, such as market indicators **28**.

[0101] Clients **20** are various users of system **10** that may place a bet **22** comprising bet parameters **24** and that may receive bet results **26**. Clients **20** may also refer to the devices used by various users of system **10**. Examples of these devices include a computer, a personal digital assistant, a mobile phone, a kiosk or point of sale terminal, a Microsoft Surface, or any other device that can interoperate with the elements of system **10** to perform the functions described herein. In a particular embodiment, clients **20** comprise physical slot machines. In other embodiments, clients **20** comprise devices, such as those described above, that can display a virtual slot machine to a user. FIG. 2 illustrates one example of such a slot machine **20**.

[0102] Referring to FIG. 2, slot machine **20**, whether physical or virtual, includes any suitable number of reels **102**, paylines **104**, and symbols **106**. Each reel **102** comprises a cylindrical spinning piece, or virtual display thereof, around which a plurality of symbols **106** are displayed. Each payline **104** comprises a payline **104** (e.g., horizontal, vertical, diagonal, or other) in the visible playing section of the slot machine **20**. Each symbol **106** comprises a graphic, picture, alphanumeric character, image, and/or icon that is displayed on reel **102**. Symbols **106** may comprise, for example, blanks, cherries, bananas, oranges, diamonds, bells, lemons, numbers, bars, double bars, or any other recognizable images. The more reels **102** that are associated with slot machine **20**, the more permutations or possible combinations of symbols **106** are able to appear on the one or more paylines **104**. The particular slot machine **20** illustrated in FIG. 2 is only one type of slot machine **20**. The look and feel of slot machine **20** could change based on any number of factors associated with system **10**, such as the type of data that is used to create the inputs for slot machine **20**. For example, if financial information **64** is used, then the look and feel of slot machine **20** (e.g., symbols **106**, buttons, display, etc.) may be customized for financial markets.

[0103] Referring back to FIG. 1, communication networks **30** and **50** may comprise any suitable number and combination of local area networks, wide area networks (e.g., the Internet), wireless networks, and/or any other type of network that transfers data between controller **40** and the other elements of system **10**, such as clients **20** and data sources **60**. Although illustrated as two separate networks, all, or a portion of networks **30** and **50** may be common to one another. Moreover, all or a portion of communication networks **30** and **50** may be a proprietary network. The transfer of data on network **30** may include the transfer of bets **22** and bet results **26**. The transfer of data on network **50** may include a transfer of event data requests **62**, such as financial market requests **62**, and event information **64**, such as financial market information **64**.

[0104] Controller **40** comprises a processor **42** coupled to a memory **44**. Processor **42** may comprise any suitable processor, such as a central processing unit (CPU) or other microprocessor and may include any suitable number of processors working together. Memory **44** may comprise any suitable combination of volatile and/or non-volatile memory that stores bets **22**, bet parameters **24**, bet results **26**, event data requests **62**, event information **64**, gaming rules **66**, input values **68**, input symbols **70** (used interchangeably with symbols **106**), payouts **72**, and/or wagering system software application **80**. Processor **42** may execute application **80** to process bets **22** based at least in part upon event information **64**. Although the description detailed below discusses controller **40** performing particular functions, it should be understood that some or all of the functions described as being performed by controller **40** may be performed by clients **20**. Functions described may be performed in alternative forms and/or not performed at all in various embodiments.

[0105] Data sources **60** comprise any suitable source of real-time or substantially real-time event information **64**. For example, data sources **60** may comprise a source of financial market information **64**, such as market centers, market data vendors, news services, and the like. Financial market information **64** may comprise information regarding the value, price, volume, and/or any other suitable indicator of a financial market index or any other suitable financial instrument (e.g., stocks, bonds, futures contracts, derivatives, etc.), referred to generally as a market indicator **28**, during or at the end of a predetermined period of time or after one or more relevant transactions. The indicators, for example, may indicate a current value of a financial instrument, a range of values of a financial instrument, a rate of change of a value of a financial instrument, a direction of change of value of a financial instrument, a volume of trades of a financial instrument, a measure of liquidity of a financial instrument, a spread of a financial instrument, a bid and/or offer value for a financial instrument, and/or any other information about a financial instrument. For example, market indicator **28** may comprise the value of a certain financial market index, foreign or domestic, such as the Dow Jones Industrial Average (DJIA), the NASDAQ, the Financial Times Stock Exchange (FTSE), the S&P 500, the New York Stock Exchange, or any other suitable financial market index. In another example, market indicator **28** may comprise the value of a particular stock, bond, futures contract, or any other suitable financial instrument. Market indicator **28** may be rounded, such as to the nearest whole point (e.g., market indicator **28** of 9,314.62 may be rounded up to 9,315), and/or include any suitable number of decimal places to provide an appropriate level of granularity. Therefore, each market indicator **28** may comprise a plurality of numerical digits associated with the value of a corresponding financial market index or other financial instrument. As described in greater detail below, controller **40** may determine the outcome of bets **22** based at least in part upon the value of one or more digits that comprise a particular market indicator **28**. In some implementations, the values of an indicator may be based on historic data. In some implementations, the values of the indicators may be delayed from a current value (e.g., based on a reporting delay, a communication delay, etc.).

[0106] Although the description of system **10** is detailed with reference to financial markets, it should be understood that system **10** provides for the contingency whereby financial markets (and therefore market indicators **28**) are unavailable at a given point in time. For example, financial markets may be closed at various times of the day, on weekends, or during holidays so that market indicators **28** are unavailable at these times. In those instances, controller **40** may use event information **64** or any other information from other sources **60** to create inputs for the games, such as a slot machine game. The event information **64** may comprise any suitable numerical data that is not randomly generated but that is also not predictable. For example, the event information **64** may be related to the weather in one or more locations at a particular time; the U.S. national debt at a particular time; power consumption of a city at a particular time; the number of television shows tuned in to a particular channel or program at a particular time (e.g., television ratings); the power output of a facility at a particular time; horse race, dog race, jai alai, or other sporting event results at a particular time; or any other substantially changing numerical data that is related to non-random events. In some embodiments, numerical data for a particular time (e.g., the U.S. national debt for a particular time of a particular day) can be extrapolated or interpolated from available data points.

Slot Machine Game

[0107] In operation, controller **40** may receive bet **22** comprising bet parameters **24**. In one embodiment, bet **22** comprises a wager regarding a spin of reels **102** of slot machine **20**. In another embodiment, bet **22** comprises a wager regarding a “lottery” number. Bet parameters **24** of bet **22** comprise one or more of the identity of client **20** that originated bet **22**; the amount of bet **22**; the time bet **22** was placed; the type of bet **22** (e.g., slot machine bet, lottery bet, or other type bet); a period of time used to determine the appropriate financial market information **64**; a particular digit of a particular market indicator **28** (e.g., first digit, last digit, nth digit); and/or information that

identifies one or more financial instruments used to determine the appropriate financial market information **64**. In the embodiment where the type of bet **22** comprises a lottery bet **22**, bet parameters **24** may further include a multi-digit lottery number. Rather than individual digits, some embodiments may refer to other elements of an indicator, such as a several digits, a direction of movement, etc. An element of an indicator may include any current information and/or historic information about the indicator.

[0108] Controller **40** processes bet **22** based at least in part upon financial market information **64**. For example, suppose bet **22** specifies the DJIA, the S&P 500, and the NASDAQ as financial market indices to be used to determine the outcome of bet **22**. Suppose further that bet **22** specifies that market indicators **28** for these financial market indices should be captured ten seconds after bet **22** is placed, as represented, for example, by a timestamp associated with bet **22** (other bets **22** could indicate that the particular market indicator **28** that is used coincide in time with the timestamp communicated with the particular bet **22**). In this example, controller **40** generates a financial market request **62** for the appropriate financial market information **64**. In response to financial market request **62**, controller **40** receives the following market indicators **28** representing the value of the DJIA, the S&P 500, and the NASDAQ ten seconds after bet **22** was placed: DJIA—10,155; S&P 500—1112; and NASDAQ—1959. Suppose further that bet parameters **24** of bet **22** specified the use of the last digit of each of these market indicators **28** to determine input values **68**. Controller **40** therefore determines a first input value **68** of “5” (e.g., the last digit of the market indicator **28** associated with the DJIA); a second input value **68** of “2” (e.g., the last digit of the market indicator **28** associated with the S&P 500); and a third input value **68** of “9” (e.g., the last digit of the market indicator **28** associated with the NASDAQ).

[0109] In other examples, input values **68** may be determined based on other digits of market indicator **28** or by applying any suitable mathematical formula that uses one or more digits of one or more market indicators **28** as operands. In still other examples, a second input value **68** may be based at least in part upon a second digit of a first market indicator **28** (e.g., first input value **68** is the *n*th digit of DJIA and second input value **68** is the *m*th digit of DJIA).

[0110] Controller **40** determines the outcome of bet **22** based upon the first input value **68**, the second input value **68**, and the third input value **68**. For example, suppose that bet **22** comprises a slot machine type bet **22**. In this example, controller **40** maps the particular input values **68** to appropriate input symbols **70** for slot machine **20**, according to rules **66**. In particular, controller **40** maps the first input value **68** to a first input symbol **70** for a first reel **102** of slot machine **20**. Controller **40** maps the second input value **68** to a second input symbol **70** for a second reel **102** of slot machine **20**. Controller **40** maps the third input value **68** to a third input symbol **70** for a third reel **102** of slot machine **20**. The first reel **102**, the second reel **102**, and the third reel **102** may be arranged in any suitable order in the slot machine **20**, so that the ordering of the particular market indicators **28** when applied to reels **102** of slot machine **20** may comprise one of “529,” “592,” “259,” “295,” “952,” or “925” based upon rules **66** and/or bet parameters **24**.

[0111] Rules **66** may specify a mapping of numeric digits to particular input symbols **70**. For example, rules **66** may specify the following mapping: [0112] “0”=Blank [0113] “1”=Cherry [0114] “2”=Banana [0115] “3”=Orange [0116] “4”=Diamond [0117] “5”=Bell [0118] “6”=Lemon [0119] “7”=Seven [0120] “8”=Bar [0121] “9”=Double Bar

[0122] Of course, controller **40** may use any suitable mapping of numeric digits to input symbols **70**, and the mapping provided above is only an example of one such mapping. Moreover, particular embodiments of system **10** use bonus symbols **70** to create a jackpot. For example, from time to time, any of the numeric digits from “0” to “9” could result in a bonus symbol **70**, such as a “\$,” “+,” “#,” “£,” “¥,” etc. If one or more of reels **102** results in bonus symbol **70**, then the user wins an enhanced payout **72**. For example, if one reel **102** results in a bonus symbol **70**, the user may win a higher payout **72** than normal. If two reels **102** result in a bonus symbol **70**, the user may win a still higher payout **72**. If all three reels **102** result in a bonus symbol **70**, the user may win a jackpot

payout **72**. The occurrence of bonus symbol **70** for any given reel **102** could be based upon predetermined odds. For example, the odds of receiving a bonus symbol **70** for any given reel **102** may be 100-1. The odds of receiving a bonus symbol **70** for two reels **102** would therefore be 1000-1. The odds of receiving a bonus symbol **70** for all three reels **102** would therefore be 1,000,000-1. The respective payouts **72** for each of these results could then be predicated upon the predetermined odds, taking into account a predetermined house advantage. In other embodiments, the successive outcomes of each reel may not be independent so that the odds may not be calculated in such a fashion (e.g., all the outputs of all the reels may be determined by some function of inputs rather than independently). In such embodiments, for example, the odds of the most unlikely outcome could be significantly different than they appear from the number of possible outcomes.

[0123] Using the mapping set forth above, controller **40** therefore determines that the spin of reels **102** of slot machine **20** associated with bet **22** resulted in a combination of “Bell,” “Banana,” and “Double Bar” at payline **104**. Controller **40** applies rules **66** to determine bet results **26**. That is, controller **40** applies rules **66** to determine whether this combination of symbols **70** results in a “win,” a “loss,” or a “tie”. Controller **40** also applies rules **66** to determine a particular payout **72** based upon the resulting combination of symbols **70** and the amount of bet **22**. In this regard, rules **66** include the winning combinations of symbols **70**, the payout odds associated therewith, and any other factors used to determine bet result **26** and/or payout **72**. Controller **40** communicates bet results **26** and any other data used to display the appropriate symbols **70** on reels **102** of slot machine **20**.

[0124] Controller **40** may also determine the outcome of bet **22** based upon the first input value **68**, the second input value **68**, and the third input value **68** if bet **22** comprises a lottery type bet **22**. In this example, suppose bet parameters **24** associated with bet **22** specified a multi-digit lottery number of “529” and specified that this number was to be formed using the last digit of the DJIA, S&P 500, and NASDAQ, in that order, ten seconds after bet **22** was placed. Based upon the market indicators **28** described above, controller **40** determines a winning number of “529.” In other examples, the winning number may be determined by applying any suitable mathematical formula that uses one or more determined input values **68** (or market indicators **28**) as the operands.

[0125] Controller **40** may compare the multi-digit lottery number of “529” specified by bet parameters **24** with the winning number “529” determined according to financial market information **64** to determine the outcome of lottery type bet **22**. In this example, controller **40** determines that bet **22** “wins.” Controller **40** determines an appropriate payout **72** for the winning bet **22** based at least in part upon the amount of bet **22** and/or the payout odds associated with bet **22** as specified by rules **66**. For example, with respect to a three-digit lottery type bet **22**, rules **66** may specify payout odds of 500-1. Therefore, if the amount of bet **22** was \$1, then payout **72** would comprise \$500.00.

[0126] FIG. **3** illustrates a flowchart **110** depicting one example method for wagering based on market indicators **28**. At step **112**, controller **40** receives bet **22** from client **20**. Bet **22** may specify particular financial instruments and a predetermined period of time to be used to determine one or more market indicators **28**. For example, bet **22** may specify to capture market indicators **28** for the DJIA, the S&P 500, and the NASDAQ ten seconds after bet **22** is placed. Bet **22** may further specify additional bet parameters **24**. Controller **40** communicates appropriate financial market requests **62** at step **114** and receives appropriate financial market information **64** at step **116**. In other embodiments, controller **40** may simply capture the appropriate financial market information **64** without issuing any requests **62**. In still other embodiments when market indicators **28** are unavailable, controller **40** captures other event information **64** for use in later steps of the method.

[0127] Execution proceeds to step **118** where controller **40** determines input values **68** based upon the financial market information **64** received at step **116**. Controller **40** may determine any suitable number of input values **68** from any suitable number and combination of market indicators **28**

using any suitable techniques described in greater detail above with regard to FIG. 1. From here, execution proceeds along path **120** if bet **22** is a slot machine type bet **22**, and along path **122** if bet **22** is a lottery type bet **22**. In other embodiments, the ordering may be based on some other indicator or any other desired thing. For example, in some embodiments, the ordering may be based on the value of the indicators, a value range of another indicator, the direction the indicators last moved, and/or any other desired thing.

[0128] Proceeding along path **120**, controller **40** maps input values **68** determined at step **118** to input symbols **70** at step **124**. Controller **40** determines the arrangement of input symbols **70** on the one or more paylines **104** of slot machine **20** at step **126**. This arrangement may be based at least in part upon bet parameters **24**. For example, bet parameters **24** may dictate that market indicators **28** for the DJIA, the S&P 500, and the NASDAQ should be used in that specific order.

[0129] Proceeding along path **122**, controller **40** determines the winning number, at step **130**, based at least in part upon the particular input values **68** determined at step **118**. Controller **40** compares the winning number determined at step **130** to the lottery number specified by bet **22**, at step **132**.

[0130] Whether execution proceeded along path **120** or path **122**, execution now proceeds to step **134** where controller **40** determines one or more outcomes of bet **22** and payouts **72**. Controller **40** communicates bet results **136** to client **20** at step **136**. Execution terminates at step **138**.

Slot Machine Game With Symbol Matrix

[0131] FIG. 4 illustrates another embodiment of a slot machine that may be used in system **10**. As with the slot machine **20** of FIG. 2, slot machine **200** includes any suitable number of reels **102**, paylines **104**, and symbols **106**. Slot machine **200** further includes a symbol matrix **210**. Symbol matrix **210** comprises an n-dimensional array of symbols **106**. As illustrated, symbol matrix **210** is a two-dimensional array having rows **212** of symbols **106** that intersect with columns **214** of symbols **106**. Rows **212** and columns **214** are associated with input values **68**. As described above, input values **68** may be determined according to the values of one or more digits of one or more market indicators **28** at various points in time. Each symbol **106** associated with a particular reel **102** may be determined according to an intersection of rows **212** and columns **214** based at least in part on input values **68**. Slot machine **200** further includes a timer **230**, input selections **232**, and betting windows **234**.

[0132] In operation, controller **40** receives bet **22** comprising bet parameters **24**. In one embodiment, bet **22** comprises a bet regarding a spin of the reels **102** of slot machine **200**.

Alternatively, or in addition, bet **22** comprises a bet regarding a lottery number selected in betting windows **234**. Bet parameters **24** associated with bet **22** comprise one or more of the identity of the particular client **20** that originated bet **22**; the amount of bet **22**; the time bet **22** was placed; the type of bet **22** (e.g., slot machine bet, lottery bet, or other type bet); one or more periods of time used to determine the appropriate financial market information **64**; a particular digit of market indicator **28** (e.g., first digit, last digit, nth digit); and information that identifies one or more financial instruments used to determine the appropriate financial market information **64** (e.g., from input selections **232**). In the embodiment where the type of bet **22** comprises a lottery bet **22**, bet parameters **24** may further comprise multiple symbols **106** that are selected in betting windows **234**. This bet **22** is therefore a bet on the predicted composition of symbols **106** associated with reels **102** of slot machine **200**.

[0133] Controller **40** processes the received bet **22** based at least in part upon financial market information **64**. For example, suppose bet **22** specifies the FTSE and the DJIA as market indicators **28** to be used to determine the outcome of bet **22**. Suppose further that bet **22** specifies that these market indicators **28** should be captured ten seconds, twenty seconds, and thirty seconds after the bet **22** is placed, as represented, for example, by a timestamp associated with bet **22**. In this example, controller **40** generates a financial market request **62** for the appropriate financial market information **64**. In response to the financial market request **62**, controller **40** may receive the following market indicators **28** representing the value of the FTSE and the DJIA at the appropriate

time intervals specified in the bet: [0134] After ten seconds: FTSE—4,460.10 [0135] DJIA—10319.20 [0136] After twenty seconds: FTSE—4,460.17 [0137] DJIA—10319.26 [0138] After thirty seconds: FTSE—4,460.05 [0139] DJIA—10,319.07

[0140] Suppose further that bet parameters **24** of the received bet **22** specified the use of the last digit of each of these market indicators **28** to determine input values **68** for each time interval of bet **22**. For the first time interval of ten seconds after bet **22** is placed, controller **40** therefore determines a first input value **68** of “0” (e.g., the last digit of the market indicator **28** associated with the FTSE), and a second input value **68** of “0” (e.g., the last digit of the market indicator **28** associated with the DJIA). Controller **40** then determines that the intersection of “0” and “0” in the symbol matrix **210** corresponds to the symbol **106** of “BAR”. Controller **40** therefore associates the symbol **106** of “BAR” with the first reel **102** of slot machine **200**.

[0141] For the second time interval of twenty seconds after the bet **22** is placed, controller **20** determines a first input value **68** of “7” (e.g., the last digit of the market indicator **28** associated with the FTSE), and a second input value **68** of “6” (e.g., the last digit of the market indicator **28** associated with the DJIA). Controller **40** then determines that the intersection of “7” and “6” in the symbol matrix **210** corresponds to the symbol **106** of “£”. Controller **40** therefore associates the symbol **106** of “£” with the second reel **102** of slot machine **200**.

[0142] For the third time interval of thirty seconds after bet **22** is placed, controller **20** determines a first input value **68** of “5” (e.g., the last digit of the market indicator **28** associated with the FTSE), and a second input value **68** of “7” (e.g., the last digit of the market indicator **28** associated with the DJIA). Controller **40** then determines that the intersection of “5” and “7” in the symbol matrix **210** corresponds to the symbol **106** of a “Cherry.” Controller **40** therefore associates the symbol **106** of a cherry with the third reel **102** of slot machine **200**.

[0143] Controller **40** therefore determines that the spin of reels **102** of slot machine **200** associated with bet **22** resulted in a combination of “BAR,” “£,” and “Cherry” at payline **104**. Controller **40** applies rules **66** to determine bet results **26** based on this combination of symbols **106**. That is, controller **40** applies rules **66** to determine whether this combination of symbols **106** results in a “win,” a “loss,” or a “tie”. Controller **40** also applies rules **66** to determine a particular payout **72** based upon the resulting combination of symbols **106** and the amount of bet **22**. In this regard, rules **66** include the winning combinations of symbols **106**, the payout odds associated therewith, and any other factors used to determine a bet result **26** and/or payout **72**. Controller **40** communicates bet results **26** and any other data used to display the appropriate symbols **106** on reels **102** of slot machine **200** (e.g., as symbols **106**).

[0144] In other examples, the particular input values **68** may be determined based on other digits of market indicators **28** or by applying any suitable mathematical formula that uses one or more digits of one or more market indicators **28** as operands. In still other examples, the symbols **106** for different reels **102** of slot machine **200** may be derived from different market indicators **28**. In particular, referring back to the example above, the symbol **106** for the second reel **102** of slot machine **200** may be derived from the value of a digit of market indicators **28** besides the FTSE and the DJIA. Moreover, the symbol **106** for the second reel **102** of slot machine **200** may be derived from the value of a digit of one or the other of the FTSE and the DJIA in combination with the value of a digit of a market indicator **28** besides the FTSE and the DJIA. In this regard, any suitable combinations of market indicators **28**, functions/mappings, and/or digits associated therewith can be used to derive the symbols **106** of the different reels **102** of slot machine **200**.

[0145] In one embodiment, the symbols **106** of symbol matrix **210** may change until bet **22** is placed, at which time they become fixed. Alternatively, or in addition, the symbols **106** may change in between the various time intervals and become fixed at the expiration of each of the time intervals. For example, symbols **106** in symbol matrix **210** may be constantly changing until bet **22** is placed and the first time interval expires, such as ten seconds after bet **22** is placed. At this point in time, symbols **106** become fixed so that a particular symbol **106** may be determined for the first

reel **102** of slot machine **200**. Once the symbol **106** for the first reel **102** is determined, symbols **106** in symbol matrix **210** may continue to change until the expiration of the second time interval, such as twenty seconds after bet **22** is placed. At this point in time, symbols **106** in symbol matrix **210** become fixed once again so that a particular symbol **106** may be determined for the second reel **102** of slot machine **200**. Once the symbol **106** for the second reel **102** is determined, symbols **106** in symbol matrix **210** may again continue to change until the expiration of the third time interval, such as thirty seconds after bet **22** is placed. At this point in time, symbols **106** in symbol matrix **210** become fixed once again so that a particular symbol **106** may be determined for the third reel **102** of slot machine **200**.

[0146] Controller **40** may also determine the outcome of a lottery type bet **22**. In this example, suppose bet parameters **24** associated with a particular lottery type bet **22** predicted the composition of symbols **106** to be “2,” “4,” and “9” as illustrated in FIG. **4**. Based upon the market indicators **28** described above, and the resulting symbols **106** that appear on payline **104** (e.g., “BAR,” “£,” and “Cherry”), controller **40** would determine that none of the symbols **106** of the lottery type bet **22** match the symbols **106** appearing in the payline **104**. Therefore, controller **40** would determine the lottery type bet **22** to be a “loss.” In particular embodiments, the controller **40** could determine the result of bet **22** (e.g., a “win,” “loss,” or “tie”) and payout **72** associated therewith based on the number and type of symbols **106** from bet **22** that match the symbols **106** ultimately appearing in payline **104** of slot machine **200**. Payout **72** could further be determined based on the amount of bet **22** and/or the payout odds associated with such a bet **22** as specified by rules **66**. In other embodiments, the symbols to appear on the payline may be determined after the payout is determined from a set of symbols that would provide the payout.

[0147] FIG. **5** illustrates a flowchart **300** depicting one example method for wagering based on multiple market indicators **28**. At step **302**, controller **40** receives bet **22** from client **20**. Bet **22** may specify particular bet parameters **24**. Controller **40** communicates appropriate financial market requests **62** at step **304** and receives appropriate financial market information **64** at step **306**. In other embodiments, controller **40** may simply capture the appropriate financial market information **64** without issuing any requests **62**. In still other embodiments when market indicators **28** are unavailable, controller **40** captures other event information **64** for use in later steps of the method.

[0148] Execution may proceed to step **308** where controller **40** determines the input values **68** based upon the financial market information **64** received at step **306**. Controller **40** may determine any suitable number of input values **68** from any suitable number and combination of market indicators **28** using any suitable techniques described in greater detail above with regard to FIG. **4**. At step **310**, controller **40** maps input values **68** determined at step **308** to a symbol **106** using matrix **210**. Controller **40** arranges the symbol **106** determined at step **310** onto a particular reel **102** at payline **104** at step **312**.

[0149] If another period of time associated with timer **230** is applicable, as determined at step **314**, controller **40** repeats any suitable number and combination of steps **304-312** to determine and arrange another symbol **106** on another reel **102** at payline **104**. In some embodiments, one or more of steps **304-308** are performed only once to determine the appropriate input values **68** used to determine the symbols **106** used in steps **310-312**. If another period of time is not applicable, as determined at step **314**, execution proceeds to step **316** where controller **40** determines the outcome and payout of the bet **22** on payline **104**. If a lottery type bet **22** was also placed, execution proceeds to step **318** where controller **40** determines the outcome and payout of the lottery bet **22**. The bet results are communicated to the client **20** at step **320** and execution terminates at step **322**.

Slot Machine Game With Stop Buttons

[0150] In some embodiments, client **20** may provide a slot machine game that comprises one or more stop buttons **402** associated with market indicators **28**. FIG. **6** illustrates client **20** that is operable to provide a game that includes stop buttons **402**. In particular, client **20** may comprise one or more indicator frames **404**, one or more input frames **406**, and one or more stop buttons **402**.

[0151] Indicator frame **404** generally displays a value of market indicator **28**. Client **20** may update the value of market indicator **28** displayed in indicator frame **404** in real time or substantially real time. Thus, as the value of a particular market indicator **28** fluctuates due to changing market conditions, client **20** may update indicator frame **404** to display the current value of market indicator **28**. The value of market indicator **28** displayed in indicator frame **404** may be updated at any suitable rate (e.g., one hundred times per second, twenty times per second, etc.). Client **20** may update the value in indicator frame **404** at a rate that is faster or slower than the typical human reaction time. For example, if the typical human reaction time is 0.2 seconds, client **20** may update the value of market indicator **28** in indicator frame **404** at a rate of ten times per second.

[0152] In some embodiments, client **20** displays a respective indicator frame **404** for each of a plurality of market indicators **28**. Each indicator frame **404** may display the value of a respective market indicator **28**. In a given indicator frame **404**, the value of market indicator **28** may be rounded to any suitable number of digits. For example, the value of a particular market indicator **28** may be rounded to the ones place, the second decimal place, the fourth decimal place, and/or to any suitable level of granularity. According to certain embodiments, as market conditions change, digits at the more granular levels (e.g., the fourth decimal place) of market indicator **28** may change more frequently than digits at the less granular levels (e.g., the tens place).

[0153] In some embodiments, a particular decimal or integral place of market indicator **28** in indicator frame **404** may be designated as input value **68**. For example, in the illustrated embodiment, the fourth decimal place in indicator frame **404** is designated as input value **68**. It should be understood, however, that any suitable digit of market indicator **28** (e.g., the tens place, the first decimal place, etc.) may be designated as input value **68**.

[0154] Client **20** may display one or more input frames **406**. In some embodiments, each input frame **406** corresponds to a respective indicator frame **404**. Input frame **406** generally displays input value **68** from the particular market indicator **28** in the corresponding indicator frame **404**. As explained above, client **20** may update the value of market indicator **28** in indicator frame **404** in real time or substantially real time. As market indicator **28** in indicator frame **404** changes, client **20** may update input frame **406** to display the current input value **68**.

[0155] An example illustrates certain embodiments. In this example, indicator frame **404** displays the current value of the DJIA, which is updated ten times per second. At 10:32:27.3 a.m., indicator frame **404** displays the current value of the DJIA, which is 13,824.8233. In this example, input value **68** is the fourth decimal place of the DJIA. Accordingly, input frame **406** associated with the first indicator frame **404** displays the digit “3”. At 10:32:27.4, client **20** updates indicator frame **404** to display the current value of the DJIA, which has changed to 13,824.8736. In conjunction with updating the value of the DJIA in indicator frame **404**, client **20** updates input frame **406** to display the digit “6”—the new input value **68** (i.e., digit in the fourth decimal place). Thus, in conjunction with updating market indicator **28** displayed in indicator frame **404**, client **20** may update input value **68** displayed in input frame **406**.

[0156] The components displayed by client **20** may be physical and/or virtual. In some embodiments, client **20** comprises one or more display panels. A display panel of client **20** may be an electronic display and/or a mechanical display such as, for example, a split-flap display. The display panel may be a touch screen, an LCD display, cathode ray tube (CRT) display, plasma display, and/or any suitable display device. The display panel of client **20** is generally operable to display any suitable information associated with a slot machine game.

[0157] According to certain embodiments, client **20** comprises one or more stop controls **402**. In the illustrated embodiment, the stop controls include stop buttons **402**. In some embodiments, each stop button **402** corresponds to a respective input frame **406**. In other embodiments, client **20** comprises one stop button **402** for all input frames **406**. Stop button **402** may be actuated by a user of client **20**. Upon detecting the actuation of stop button **402**, client **20** may “freeze” input value **68** displayed in input frame **406**. In other words, the actuation of stop button **402** may stop client **20**

from further updating the displayed input value **68**. Thus, at the moment stop button **402** is actuated, the particular input value **68** that is displayed in input frame **406** may be frozen. In other embodiments, some amount of delay may occur before the symbols are frozen. System **10** may then use the frozen input value **68** to determine the outcome of bet **22**. In conjunction with freezing input value **68** in input frame **406**, client **20** may freeze the value of market indicator **28** in indicator frame **404** at the moment stop button **402** is actuated.

[0158] Stop control **402** may be any suitable input device. In some embodiments, stop control **402** may be a portion of a touch screen display of client **20**. Such a display may interpret gestures to determine a stop request. In other embodiments, stop control **402** may be a switch, push button, key, keyboard, keypad, mouse, remote control, and/or any suitable input device. In yet other embodiments, stop control **402** may be a microphone and/or sensor that detects audible signals such as, for example, voice commands. Stop control **402** may be any suitable input device that may be activated by a user to “freeze” input value **68** in input frame **406**.

[0159] According to certain embodiments, client **20** may display an indicator table **408** to a user. Indicator table **408** may comprise a plurality of market indicators **28**. In conjunction with submitting bet **22**, a user may select one or more market indicators **28** from indicator table **408**. Client **20** may display the selected financial market indicator(s) **28** in indicator frame(s) **404**. Thus, a user may select the particular financial market indicator(s) **28** for a given game.

[0160] In operation, client **20** receives bet **22** from a user. In some embodiments, client **20** displays indicator table **408** that comprises a plurality of market indicators **28**. The user then selects a plurality of market indicators **28** from indicator table **408**. Client **20** displays the current value of the first selected market indicator **28** in a first indicator frame **404**, the current value of the second selected market indicator **28** in a second indicator frame **404**, and so forth.

[0161] Client **20** may update, in real time or substantially real time, the values of market indicators **28** in the respective indicator frames **404**. A respective decimal or integral place of each indicator frame **404** may be designated as input value **68**. For each indicator frame **404**, client **20** displays the current input value **68** in a respective input frame **406**. As client **20** updates the values of market indicators **28** in indicator frames **404**, client **20** updates input values **68** in the corresponding input frames **406**.

[0162] Client **20** may update market indicators **28** and input values **68** according to any suitable rate. In some embodiments, client **20** updates market indicators **28** and input values **68** at a rate that is faster than the typical human reaction time.

[0163] After placing bet **22** and selecting market indicators **28**, the user may view the changing input values **68** in input frames **406**. The user may freeze input value **68** in a given input frame **406** by actuating stop button **402** corresponding to the given input frame **406**. Upon detecting actuation of stop button **402**, client **20** may stop the corresponding input value **68** from further changing. By choosing when to depress stop button **402** for each input frame **406**, the user may try to obtain a particular combination of digits in input frames **406**.

[0164] After the user has actuated the respective stop button **402** for each input frame **406**, client **20** may determine a payout. The payout may be based at least in part on the combination of digits that are frozen in input frames **406**. In some embodiments, the user may receive a first payout if the user stopped input values **68** such that all input frames **406** display the same digit. The user may receive a second payout if the user stopped input values **68** such that two or more input frames **406** (but less than all input frames **406**) of client **20** display the same digit. The user may receive a third payout if the displayed digits in input frames **406** represent a “straight.” The user may receive a fourth payout if each of the displayed digits in input frames **406** is an even digit or an odd digit. Rules **66** associated with client **20** may specify any suitable payout associated with any suitable combination of digits.

[0165] An example illustrates certain embodiments. A user submits bet **22** to client **20**, which comprises three indicator frames **404**. Client **20** prompts the user to select three market indicators

28 from indicator table **408**. In this example, the user selects the DJIA, the S&P 500, and the FTSE. Client **20** then displays the DJIA in the first indicator frame **404**, the S&P 500 in the second indicator frame **404**, and the FTSE in the third indicator frame **404**.

[0166] In this example, client **20** updates the values of market indicators **28** in indicator frames **404** at a rate of ten times per second. The fourth decimal place of each market indicator **28** is designated as a respective input value **68**. Client **20** displays input value **68** in input frame **406** associated with indicator frame **404**. In conjunction with updating market indicators **28** in indicator frames **404**, client **20** updates input values **68** in input frames **406**. Thus, in the present example, client **20** displays to user input values **68** that (i) are changing at a predetermined rate (i.e., ten times per second) and (ii) are from the selected market indicators **28**.

[0167] In the present example, client **20** provides a high payout if the user freezes input frames **406** such that each input value **68** is the same. Client **20** provides a medium payout if the user freezes input frames **406** such that two input values **68** are the same. In this example, the user actuates the first stop button **402** when the value of the DJIA that is displayed in the first indicator frame **404** is 13,824.8736. Accordingly, input frame **406** associated with the DJIA is frozen with a value of six (i.e., the digit in the fourth decimal place).

[0168] In this example, the user then actuates the second stop button **402** when the value of the S&P 500 that is displayed in the second indicator frame **404** is 1,484.2379. Accordingly, input frame **406** associated with the S&P 500 is frozen with a value of nine (i.e., the digit in the fourth decimal place). The user then actuates the third stop button **402** when the value of the FTSE that is displayed in the third indicator frame **404** is 6,289.2746. Accordingly, input frame **406** associated with the FTSE is frozen with a value of six (i.e., the digit in the fourth decimal place).

[0169] Thus, in this example, the game ends with client **20** displaying the following combination of input values **68**: six-nine-six. In this example, because two input values **68** are the same (i.e., two sixes), client **20** provides a medium payout to the user.

[0170] In the foregoing example, the DJIA, S&P 500, and FTSE are the selected market indicators **28**. It should be understood, however, that client **20** may display any suitable number and combination of market indicators **28**.

[0171] In the foregoing example, input value **68** is the fourth decimal place of market indicator **28**. It should be understood, however, that input value **68** may be any suitable decimal or integral place of market indicator **28**. It should be further understood that input value **68** for a first market indicator **28** may be associated with a different decimal or integral place than input value **68** for a second market indicator **28**.

[0172] In some embodiments, each time a reel is determined to be a winning reel, a player may be offered a chance to continue playing an additional reel for a higher payout chance. Some embodiments may have a maximum number of reels. Other embodiments may continue offering additional reels until a player loses. Each additional reel may have a higher payout than a previous reel. Each time a player chooses to play another reel, the player may risk losing some or all winnings won from prior reels for the chance of winning the higher payout.

[0173] In some embodiments, client **20** may further comprise a surrender button **410** and a wild frame **412**. According to certain embodiments, a user may actuate surrender button **410** to surrender the game prior to actuating all stop buttons **402**. By surrendering the game, the user may be refunded a portion of bet **22**. In some embodiments, in which additional reels are offered for play after winning earlier reels, a surrender button may be pressed to end play and accept currently accumulated winnings.

[0174] As an example, suppose client **20** comprises three input frames **406**. Client **20** may be associated with a payout table that specifies a first payout for three-of-a-kind and a second payout for two-of-a-kind. In this example, the user actuates the first stop button **402** such that the first input frame **406** displays a “3”. The user then actuates the second stop button **402** such that the second input frame **406** displays a “7”. At this point, the user knows that the result will not be

three-of-a-kind. Prior to actuating the third stop button **402**, the user may choose to surrender the game and forego the chance of obtaining two-of-a-kind. In some embodiments, if the user surrenders the game, the user may be refunded a portion of bet **22**.

[0175] According to certain embodiments, client **20** displays a wild frame **412**. Wild frame **412** may comprise a digit that is designated as wild. The wild digit may be considered to have whatever value is most favorable to the user. In some embodiments, at the start of the game, the user may select which digit is to be the wild digit.

[0176] An example illustrates certain embodiments. Assume that client **20** displays three input frames **406**. At the start of a game, the user selects “2” as the wild digit. The user then plays the game. By actuating the respective stop buttons **402**, the user freezes input frames **406** such that the following combination is displayed: two-five-five. Because wild frame **412** designates “2” as wild, client **20** determines that the user has obtained a three-of-a-kind. Client **20** then provides an appropriate payout.

[0177] In some embodiments, client **20** may comprise a single stop button **402** for all input frames **406**. Thus, all of the input frames **406** may be frozen at the particular moment that the user actuates the single stop button **402**. In other embodiments, client **20** may not comprise stop button **402**. Client **20** may be configured to stop (freeze) each input frame **406** a predetermined amount of time after the user submits bet **22** and/or pulls a lever. For example, client **20** may be configured to freeze each input frame **406** three seconds, five seconds, and/or any suitable amount of time after the user submits bet **22**.

[0178] FIG. 7 illustrates client **20** that provides a slot machine game in which one or more stop buttons **402** correspond to reels **102** that spin independently of market indicators **28**, according to certain embodiments. Client **20** may comprise a plurality of reels **102**, and each reel **102** may comprise a plurality of digits. For example, a particular reel **102** may comprise digits “0” through “9”. In response to bet **22**, a start command, or actuation of a lever, the reels **102** of client **20** may begin to spin.

[0179] In some embodiments, each reel **102** may be associated with a respective indicator frame **404**. Each indicator frame **404** may display a corresponding market indicator **28**. Client **20** is operable to update market indicator **28** in indicator frame **404** in real time or substantially real time. In some embodiments, a particular decimal or integral place of market indicator **28** in indicator frame **404** may be designated as input value **68**. For example, in the illustrated embodiment, the fourth decimal place in indicator frame **404** is designated as input value **68**. It should be understood, however, that any suitable digit of market indicator **28** (e.g., the tens place, the first decimal place, etc.) may be designated as input value **68**.

[0180] In some embodiments, reels **102** of client **20** may spin independently of market indicators **28** in indicator frames **404**. Thus, the particular digit on reel **102** that is displayed at payline **104** may or may not be the same as input value **68** from the corresponding market indicator **28**.

[0181] In some embodiments, each reel **102** of client **20** may correspond to a respective stop button **402**. When a user actuates a particular stop button **402**, client **20** may (i) stop the corresponding reel **102** and (ii) freeze the value of market indicator **28** in the corresponding indicator frame **404**. To freeze the value of market indicator **28**, client **20** may stop updating the displayed value of market indicator **28**. When stop button **402** is actuated and reel **102** is stopped, the digit on reel **102** that is positioned at payline **104** may be referred to as stop value **414**. System **10** may compare stop value **414** of a particular reel **102** with input value **68** from the corresponding market indicator **28**, which has been frozen. In some embodiments, if stop value **414** from the stopped reel **102** is the same as input value **68** from market indicator **28**, then reel **102** may be considered a winning reel **102**. According to certain embodiments, the payout for bet **22** may be based at least in part on the number of winning reels **102**.

[0182] An example illustrates certain embodiments. Client **20** displays three reels **102**. Each reel **102** comprises the digits “0” through “9”. At the start of the game, the user selects three market

indicators **28** from indicator table **408**. In this example, the user selects the DJIA, the S&P 500, and the NASDAQ. Accordingly, client **20** displays the current value of the DJIA in the first indicator frame **404**, the current value of the S&P 500 in the second indicator frame **404**, and the current value of the NASDAQ in the third indicator frame **404**. Client **20** may update the displayed values of market indicators **28** in real time or substantially real time. In this example, the fourth decimal place of each market indicator **28** is designated as input value **68**.

[0183] In this example, after selecting the three market indicators **28**, the user inputs a start command that causes reels **102** to start spinning. As reels **102** are spinning, client **20** updates indicator frames **404** at any suitable rate (e.g., ten times per second, twenty times per second, etc.).

[0184] While reels **102** are spinning, the user actuates stop button **402** associated with the first reel **102** (i.e., the particular reel **102** associated with the DJIA). Upon detecting the actuation of stop button **402**, client **20** (i) stops the first reel **102** and (ii) freezes the current value of the DJIA displayed in the first indicator frame **404**. In this example, the first reel **102** is stopped such that stop value **414** (i.e., digit displayed at payline **104**) is four. In this example, at the moment the user actuates stop button **402**, client **20** freezes the current value of the DJIA in indicator frame **404**, which is 12,873.5124. Accordingly, input value **68** from the first indicator frame **404** is four (i.e., digit in the fourth decimal place). Because input value **68** and stop value **414** are the same, client **20** determines that the first reel **102** is a winning reel **102**.

[0185] The user then actuates stop button **402** associated with the second reel **102** (i.e., the particular reel **102** associated with the S&P 500). Upon detecting the actuation of stop button **402**, client **20** (i) stops the second reel **102** and (ii) freezes the current value of the S&P 500 displayed in the second indicator frame **404**. In this example, the second reel **102** is stopped such that stop value **414** is eight. In this example, at the moment the user actuates stop button **402**, client **20** freezes the current value of the S&P 500 in indicator frame **404**, which is 1,427.2465. Accordingly, input value **68** from the second indicator frame **404** is five (i.e., digit in the fourth decimal place). Because stop value **414** from the second reel **102** (i.e., eight) is not the same as input value **68** from the second indicator frame **404** (i.e., five), client **20** determines that the second reel **102** is not a winning reel **102**.

[0186] The user then actuates stop button **402** associated with the third reel **102** (i.e., the particular reel **102** associated with the NASDAQ). Upon detecting the actuation of stop button **402**, client **20** (i) stops the third reel **102** and (ii) freezes the current value of the NASDAQ displayed in the third indicator frame **404**. In this example, the third reel **102** is stopped such that stop value **414** is seven. In this example, at the moment the user actuates stop button **402**, client **20** freezes the current value of the NASDAQ in indicator frame **404**, which is 2,572.1027. Accordingly, input value **68** from the third indicator frame **404** is seven (i.e., the digit in the fourth decimal place). Because stop value **414** from the third reel **102** is the same as input value **68** from the third indicator frame **404**, client **20** determines that the third reel **102** is a winning reel **102**. Thus, in this example, client **20** determines that the first and third reels **102** are winning reels **102**. Client **20** may provide an appropriate payout according to any suitable payout table associated with client **20**.

[0187] In the foregoing example, the DJIA, S&P 500, and NASDAQ are the selected market indicators **28**. It should be understood, however, that client **20** may display any suitable number and combination of market indicators **28**.

[0188] In the foregoing example, input value **68** is the fourth decimal place of market indicator **28**. It should be understood, however, that input value **68** may be any suitable decimal or integral place of market indicator **28**. It should be further understood that input value **68** for a first market indicator **28** may be associated with a different decimal or integral place than input value **68** for a second market indicator **28**. It should also be understood that an indicator need not include a typical decimal number, but rather may include a binary number, a symbol, a direction of movement of prices, etc.

[0189] In the foregoing example, client **20** comprises a respective stop button **402** for each reel

102. In other embodiments, client **20** may comprise a single stop button **402**. In some embodiments, a first actuation of a particular stop button **402** may stop the first reel **102**, a subsequent actuation of the particular stop button **402** may stop the second reel **102**, and so forth. In other embodiments, a single actuation of a single stop button **402** may stop all reels **102**.

[0190] In some embodiments, system **10** may provide various advantages. In particular, system **10** may provide a slot machine game that is associated with one or more market indicators **28**. In some embodiments, the slot machine game includes one or more stop buttons **402**. By allowing a user to use stop buttons **402**, system **10** may give a user the perception that the user's skill or reaction time may affect the outcome of the game. In some embodiments, this perception may be illusory such as, for example, where client **20** updates the value of market indicators **28** at a rate that is faster than typical human reaction time. Nevertheless, this perception may enhance the user's enjoyment of the game.

[0191] In some embodiments, possible collusion and/or attempts to influence a market indicator may be monitored and/or prevented. For example, financial transactions associated with a player may be prevented during play, if a player wins a large enough amount of money, the financial trades which that player made may be examined to determine if any trades were made that might have affected the outcome of a game.

[0192] FIG. **8** illustrates a flowchart **500** for a slot machine game that is associated with market indicators **28** and that includes one or more stop buttons **402**, according to certain embodiments. The method begins at step **502** where client **20** receives bet **22** regarding a slot machine game. In some embodiments, bet **22** specifies the decimal or integral place of each market indicator **28** that will be used to determine input values **68**.

[0193] At step **504**, client **20** prompts the user to select one or more market indicators **28** from indicator table **408**. At step **506**, client **20** displays the selected market indicators **28** in respective indicator frames **404**. In particular, client **20** may display in a first indicator frame **404** the current value of the first selected market indicator **28**. Client **20** may display in a second indicator frame **404** the current value of the second selected market indicator **28**, and client **20** may display in a third indicator frame **404** the current value of the third selected market indicator **28**.

[0194] In conjunction with displaying the selected market indicators **28**, client **20** may display input values **68** in respective input frames **406**. For a particular input frame **406**, client **20** may determine input value **68** from a particular decimal or integral place of the corresponding market indicator **28**.

[0195] At step **508**, client **20** may update, in real time or substantially real time, market indicators **28** displayed in the respective indicator frames **404** and input values **68** displayed in the respective input frames **406**. In particular, client **20** may update market indicator **28** in indicator frame **404** in response to changing market conditions as reported by data sources **60**. Client **20** may update market indicator **28** according to any suitable rate (e.g., twenty times per second, five times per second, etc.). Thus, as market activity causes the value of market indicator **28** to change, client **20** may display to the user the changing value of market indicator **28** in indicator frame **404**.

[0196] In conjunction with updating market indicator **28** in indicator frame **404**, client **20** may update input value **68** in the corresponding input frame **406**. Input value **68** may be determined from a predetermined decimal or integral place of market indicator **28**. Thus, as the value of market indicator **28** in indicator frame **404** changes, client **20** may update the corresponding input frame **406** to display the current digit from the predetermined decimal or integral place of market indicator **28**.

[0197] At step **510**, client **20** detects, at a first point in time, actuation of a first stop button **402** associated with the first input frame **406**. In some embodiments, actuation of stop button **402** causes client **20** to receive a stop command. At step **512**, client **20** freezes input value **68** in the first input frame. Thus, input value **68** may be frozen upon actuation of the first stop button **402** at the first point in time.

[0198] At step **514**, client **20** detects, at a second point in time, actuation of a second stop button **402** associated with the second input frame **406**. At step **516**, client **20** freezes input value **68** in the second input frame **406**. At step **518**, client **20** detects, at a third point in time, actuation of a third stop button **402** associated with the third input frame **406**. At step **520**, client **20** freezes input value **68** in the third input frame **406**.

[0199] At step **522**, client **20** determines a payout for the received bet **22** based at least in part on the combination of the frozen input value **68** from the first input frame **406**, the frozen input value **68** from the second input frame **406**, and the frozen input value **68** from the third input frame **406**. In some embodiments, rules **66** associated with client **20** may specify a respective payout for different combinations of input values **68** such as, for example, three-of-a-kind, two-of-a-kind, straight, all even digits, all odd digits, and/or any suitable type of combination. At step **524**, client **20** issues the determined payout to the user. The method then ends.

[0200] It should be understood that in alternative embodiments, the present invention contemplates using methods with additional steps, fewer steps, different steps, or steps in different sequential order so long as the steps remain appropriate for wagering based on financial market indicators.

Slot Machine Game Associated With Market Line Wager

[0201] FIG. **9** illustrates client **20** that provides wagering opportunities associated with moving market indicator **28**, according to certain embodiments. Client **20** may provide an opportunity for a user to wager on whether a selected market indicator **28** will be above or below defined market levels after a configurable time period **606**. This type of wager may be referred to as a market line wager **602**. The associated time period **606** can be variable. For example, market line wager **602** may be that market indicator **28** will be above or below a particular market line after five minutes, ten minutes, at the close of trading, and/or after any suitable time period **606**. Thus, market line wager **602** may be an over-under wager associated with a defined market line.

[0202] In the illustrated example, client **20** offers eight propositions associated with a particular market indicator **28**—namely, the FTSE. Proposition may refer to an opportunity to bet on some attribute or event associated with and/or derived from market indicator **28**. In some embodiments, the eight available propositions are based on an opportunity to wager that the FTSE will close above or below four separately defined levels. A list allows a user to access any given exchange in order to place market line wager **602** associated with a given market indicator **28**.

[0203] In an example embodiment, client **20** displays a high line, the current market line, and a low line for the FTSE. The high line is a constantly moving market level—about 1% of the market value above the current market level in this example. Note that in more volatile markets (or based on particular needs), such high and low lines may be + any suitable percentage level of the current market line. The high line in this example is at 4404. The higher and lower betting opportunities may represent constant fixed odds prices. The higher odds may be odds against the current levels (a short position) and the lower odds may be odds for (supporting) current levels (a long position or “odds-on”). Thus, in an example arrangement, a set of propositions (**604a** and **604b**) reflect the short and long positions for the high line. Proposition **604a** includes odds of 5/1, while proposition **604b** includes odds of 1/12. In some embodiments, the odds and/or level of lines may change based on conditions of the market.

[0204] In some embodiments, after a bet on a market line is placed, an offsetting purchase of a financial instrument may be made. For example, if a bet is placed that an index fund will decrease in value by 50% in the next day at 12/1 odds, a purchase of an inverse exchange traded fund that is leveraged at a 12 to 1 ratio may be made. Accordingly, if the bet wins, the ETF may be sold, and the proceeds used to pay the winnings of the bet. If the bet loses, the ETF may be kept or sold and added to assets of an operator of a machine.

[0205] The current market line is moving constantly as a reflection of the actual level of market indicator **28**. This is in relation to the higher or lower betting opportunities, which may remain at static fixed odds prices (approximately 10/11 in this example). The current market line is 4354 and

includes a set of propositions (**604c** and **604d**), which represent higher and lower positions that are both accompanied by 10/11 odds. Additionally, another set of propositions (**604e** and **604f**) may be provided at derivations of the current market line. These two propositions may be offered at levels of 4361 and 4348, respectively. Thus, a second current market level (in this case where customers can bet at even money) is provided and offers an opportunity to bet on whether market indicator **28** will expire above or below a market spread. In this example, a thirteen point spread straddles the current market middle line and offers yet another betting opportunity for a user.

[0206] In some embodiments, client **20** may display a low line. This represents a constantly moving market level that will be about 1% (in this example) of the market value below the current market. The higher and lower betting opportunities reflect constant fixed odds prices in this example. The higher odds will be (long) odds-on and the lower odds will be (short) odds-against. Thus, a set of propositions (**604g** and **604h**) are again provided, reflecting the higher and lower propositions, respectively. The odds are 1/12 and 5/1 respectively for propositions **604g** and **604h**. Other expiries may also be accommodated and inclusive of intraday markets, weekend markets, and monthly and/or quarterly expirations.

[0207] The high line and low line, in addition to reflecting market movements, may move over time. The spread between the high line and the market line may grow more narrow (or closer) as the expiry draws near. This is also true for the higher evens proposition **604e** and the lower evens proposition **604f**. Thus, such lines may be floating: not only in the sense of market movements, but also as time progresses they will move and narrow. For example, with five minutes left to go for a wager, these lines may be quite narrow. Thus, the high line generally comes down (while odds remain relatively consistent) and the low line generally goes up during the course of the trading day. Note also that over time, as the expiration of time period **606** nears, certain propositions may be eliminated because of practical constraints. Markets generally move in whole number increments. Therefore, spreads that are too narrow will eliminate certain propositions (e.g. **604b** and **604g**), as time period **606** expires. This offers some constraint on such a scenario, whereby (for example) the high line and the low line cannot be any closer than five or ten ticks apart.

[0208] The propositions with 1/12 and 5/1 odds (propositions **604b**, **604g**, **604a**, and **604h**) reflect odds calculations that are determined based on their corresponding lines (i.e. 4404 and 4306). Thus, in an example market line wager **602**, consider the case where a user bets \$100 that the FTSE will be above the high line (provided as 4404) when time period **606** expires. This proposition provides 5/1 odds (identified as proposition **604a**). When time period **606** expires, assume the FTSE is at 4425. The user's market line wager **602** is a winning bet **22**. Settlement would then ensue where the user would collect \$500 from the winning bet **22** plus his original stake, which would yield \$600 total. Using the same parameters, consider a second user that opts to wager on the lower proposition. The lower proposition offers 1/12 odds (identified as proposition **604b**). If market indicator **28** is above such a prediction when time period **606** expires, the second user would lose the \$100 that he wagered. If, on the other hand, the FTSE is at 4390 when time period **606** expires, the second user would be rewarded with \$100/12 (the odds offered) plus his original stake. This would yield a return of approximately \$108.33 for the winning bet **22**.

[0209] As described above, the price that is being offered to a user, reflecting where the middle of the market is, can be provided by a communications feed from data sources **60**. This feed could reflect daily market conditions and effectively encompass news flow and other financial parameters that could potentially affect the market. Other embodiments, described more fully below, offer an owner or operator of system **10** considerable flexibility in setting market lines and odds.

[0210] In some embodiments, processor **42** is operable to establish a number of odds for a user in the context of a number of wagering opportunities. Processor **42** may transmit the established odds to client **20**, which may display the established odds to a user. In one embodiment, processor determines the odds for a particular proposition based at least in part on three factors: underlying market level, volatilities, and time. Volatility represents a measure of uncertainty exhibited by the

market over a given time period **606**. Markets generally follow log-normal distribution, which reflects an abstraction or theory that allows a person to reasonably approximate market movements. In this sense, the mathematics used to calculate odds could be similar to that of options pricing. In other scenarios, odds calculations may be based on exposure for an owner/operator of system **10**. Note that a number of control parameters are provided to an administrator of system **10**. For example, the volatility factor may be manipulated in response to breaking news that would most likely affect market levels. This judgment may be made by an administrator and reflect his or her own judgment and/or expertise in market theories. In other scenarios, such news items would automatically be priced into the financial market.

[0211] In an alternative embodiment, processor **42** determines odds for a particular proposition based on the following formula: $\text{odds} = (\text{prize value} / \text{risk value}) * \text{factor}$. Therefore, odds could be variable based (at least in part) on the prize value and the risk value. In still other embodiments, processor **42** may use or consider any number of influential factors to vary odds that are offered to users. Any number of news items, statistical data, or events may affect, or influence a given market. These factors may be taken into consideration by processor **42** and/or an administrator in setting odds. Such factors may include market news or commentary, job data, interest rate information, commodity prices, consumer spending, consumer confidence, unemployment information, economic growth, capital spending, gross domestic product (GDP) data, bond prices, or any other piece of information or data that may have an influential effect on a given market line. For example, a decrease in interest rates generally spawns an increase in the Dow Jones Industrial Average (DJIA) for that trading day. Processor **42** may calculate odds in a systematic manner (as described herein) and then factor in this information such that the odds are generally shifted to accommodate for the probability of gains in that day's market performance. In other embodiments, such information is built into the market line in a manner that is suitable to an administrator and, therefore, such manipulations are unnecessary.

[0212] In an example scenario, consider that the S&P 500 rarely performs poorly in an election year in the United States. Only twice in the history of the U.S. stock markets has the S&P 500 provided a negative return for investors during an election year. Thus, during an election year, control parameters may be implemented to reflect the conclusion that, over the course of the year, the S&P 500 is most likely to rise. Similarly, markets tend to decline in times of war or during patterns of interest rate increases. In the event of a major war or in the event that such a pattern of systematic interest rate increases is identified, an administrator could again manipulate the odds (as he or she sees fit) to reflect this probable downward trend.

[0213] Note that in other scenarios, the market line may be static or fixed over a given time period **606**, whereby the odds may be varied in order to tempt a user or to solicit additional betting. For example, if the FTSE shoots up 300 points to a level of 5000 in morning trading, the odds can be varied significantly (e.g. 50/1 or 100/1) in order to entice people to bet that the FTSE will close below the original market line. This is an unlikely occurrence. Other unlikely occurrences (involving the appreciation or depreciation of corresponding markets) may be readily appreciated and are, thus, clearly within the scope of the teachings of system **10**.

[0214] While a user that placed market line wager **602** waits for time period **606** to expire (so that the outcome of market line wager **602** may be determined), system **10** may offer to the user other betting opportunities such as, for example, a slot machine game. FIG. **10** illustrates client **20** that provides a slot machine game that is generally associated with market line wagers **602**, according to certain embodiments. In particular, client **20** may display propositions associated with a high line, a current market line, and a low line. In some embodiments, client **20** displays time period **606** associated with propositions (e.g., five minutes, ten minutes, end-of-day). The outcome of market line wager **602** may depend on the value of market indicator **28** when time period **606** expires. As explained above, a user may place market line wager **602** by selecting at least one of the displayed propositions. For example, a user may place a market line wager **602** by selecting the high line

arrow for “Bet 5/1 Higher”. Client **20** may then display the value of high line from the moment the user made the selection. User may then wait until time period **606** expires. When time period **606** expires in this example, if market indicator **28** is greater than the value of high line (from when the user made the selection), then market line wager **602** is a winning wager.

[0215] In some embodiments, while the user waits for time period **606** associated with market line wager **602** to expire (so the outcome of market line wager **602** may be determined), client **20** may provide a slot machine game that is associated with market line wager **602**. In particular, client **20** may display one or more reels **102**. Client **20** may submit a slot bet **22** in order to spin reels **102**. The reels **102** may come to a stop such that one or more symbols **106** or characters are displayed. The outcome of the slot bet **22** may be based at least in part on the displayed symbols **106** on reels **102** and the value of market line associated with market line wager **602**.

[0216] An example illustrates various embodiments. Assume client **20** displays a high line, a current market line, and a low line associated with the FTSE. Client **20** displays a plurality of propositions. Each proposition represents an opportunity to wager that, when time period **606** expires, market indicator **28** will be above or below the corresponding market line. For example, client **20** may display a first proposition with 5/1 odds that market indicator **28** will be higher than the high line when time period **606** expires. Client **20** may further display a second proposition with 1/12 odds that market indicator **28** will be lower than the high line when time period **606** expires. In this example, a user selects the first proposition (i.e., the 5/1 proposition that market indicator **28** will be higher than the high line when time period **606** expires). When the user selects the first proposition, the value of the high line is 4404. Accordingly, the market line wager **602** of user is that market indicator **28** will be above 4404 when time period **606** expires.

[0217] In this example, while the user waits for time period **606** to expire, the user plays a slot machine game offered by client **20**. In this example, client **20** displays four reels **102**. In association with reels **102**, client **20** displays the value of high line as of the moment the user placed market line wager **602**. In this example, each reel **102** comprises the digits “0” through “9” and each reel **102** corresponds to a respective digit of the displayed value of high line. To play the slot machine game, the user places a slot bet **22** and spins reels **102**. In this example, reels **102** come to a stop after a configurable period of time and/or after user actuates one or more stop buttons **402**. The stopping point for each reel **102** may be determined randomly (e.g., by a random number generator) or according to non-random, unpredictable events (e.g., the values of respective market indicators **28**, as explained above with respect to FIGS. 1-8). When reels **102** come to a stop, each reel **102** displays a respective digit at payline **104**. In this example, the first reel **102** comes to a stop such that the digit “5” is displayed, the second reel **102** comes to a stop such that the digit “1” is displayed, the third reel **102** comes to a stop such that the digit “8” is displayed, and the fourth reel **102** comes to a stop such that the digit “9” is displayed. Thus, the displayed digits form the number “5189”.

[0218] In this example, client **20** determines whether a slot bet **22** is a winning bet **22** according to the following rules: [0219] 1) If market line wager **602** is that market indicator **28** will finish higher than the value of the selected market line, then the slot bet **22** is a winning bet **22** if the number formed by the displayed digits of reels **102** is higher than the value of the selected market line.

[0220] 2) If market line wager **602** is that market indicator **28** will finish lower than the value of the selected market line, then the slot bet **22** is a winning bet **22** if the number formed by the displayed digits of reels **102** is lower than the value of the selected market line.

[0221] In this example, market line wager **602** of user is that market indicator **28** will be higher than 4404 when time period **606** expires. Thus, according to the first rule, client **20** determines that the slot bet **22** is a winning bet **22** because the number from reels **102** (i.e., 5189) is higher than 4404.

[0222] Processor **42** may determine payout **72** for the slot bet **22** according to any suitable rules. In particular, payout **72** may be based at least in part on the value of the selected market line, the

probabilities associated with various reel **102** combinations, one or more takeout criteria, and/or any suitable criteria. In some embodiments, if market indicator **28** equals the selected market line when time period **606** expires, then the outcome of slot bet **22** may be a push or may be in favor of the user or of “the house.”

[0223] In the foregoing example, client **20** displays a respective reel **102** for each digit from the selected market line. In other embodiments, client **20** may display a single reel **102**. For example, client **20** may display a single reel **102**—actual or virtual—that comprises the numbers “0” to “9999”. In such embodiments, the outcome of a slot bet **22** may be based at least in part on the number displayed by the single reel **102** when it comes to a stop. For example, if market line wager **602** is that market indicator **28** will be higher than 4404 when time period **606** expires, then a slot bet **22** may be a winning bet **22** if the single wheel stops and displays a number that is higher than 4404.

[0224] In the foregoing example, the rules for determining the outcome of a slot bet **22** correspond to the type of proposition selected for market line wager **602**. For example, if market line wager **602** is that market indicator **28** will be higher than a particular market line when time period **606** expires, then the slot bet **22** is a winning bet if the number from reel(s) **102** is higher than the particular market line. In other embodiments, however, the rules for determining the outcome of a slot bet **22** may inversely be related to the type of proposition selected for market line wager **602**. For example, if market line wager **602** is that market indicator **28** will be higher than a particular market line when time period **606** expires, then the slot bet **22** is a winning bet **22** if the number from reel(s) **102** is lower than the particular market line.

[0225] According to certain embodiments, client **20** may provide a slot machine game in which digits from reels **102** are summed or multiplied to determine outcome of a slot bet **22**. For example, assume market line wager **602** is that market indicator **28** will be higher than 4404 when time period **606** expires. In this example, client **20** may display four reels **102** wherein each reel **102** comprises the numbers “0” to “2500”. While a user waits for the outcome of market line wager **602** to be determined, the user may submit a slot bet **22** and spin the four reels **102** displayed by client **20**. In this example, the four reels **102** come to a stop such that the first reel **102** displays the number “2268”, the second reel **102** displays the number “782”, the third reels **102** displays the number “1072”, and the fourth reel **102** displays the number “173”. Thus, the sum of the displayed numbers is 4295 (i.e., 2268+782+1072+173).

[0226] In this example, client **20** determines whether a slot bet **22** is a winning bet **22** according to the following rules: [0227] 1) If market line wager **602** is that market indicator **28** will finish higher than the value of the selected market line, then the slot bet **22** is a winning bet **22** if the sum of the displayed numbers from reels **102** is higher than the value of the selected market line. [0228] 2) If market line wager **602** is that market indicator **28** will finish lower than the value of the selected market line, then the slot bet **22** is a winning bet **22** if the displayed numbers from reels **102** is lower than the value of the selected market line.

[0229] In this example, market line wager **602** is that market indicator **28** will be higher than 4404 when time period **606** expires. Thus, according to the first rule, client **20** determines that the slot bet **22** is a losing bet **22** because the sum of the displayed numbers from reels **102** (i.e., 4295) is not higher than 4404.

[0230] In the foregoing examples, reels **102** comprise digits. In other embodiments, reels **102** may comprise symbols **106**, as illustrated in FIG. 4. In some embodiments, client **20** may map symbols **106** from reels **102** to digits (or vice versa) according to any suitable symbol/digit matrix to determine whether a slot bet **22** is a winning bet **22**.

[0231] In the foregoing example, propositions and the slot machine game are associated with the FTSE. It should be understood, however, that propositions and the slot machine game may be associated with any suitable type and combination of market indicator **28**.

[0232] Although the foregoing examples illustrate particular functions being performed by client

20, it should be understood that some or all of the functions performed by client **20** may be performed by processor **42**. It should be further understood that some or all of the functions performed by processor **42** may be performed by client **20**.

[0233] FIG. **11** illustrates a flowchart **700** for managing a slot machine game associated with market line wager **602**, according to certain embodiments. The method begins at step **702** where client **20** displays one or more market lines and one or more propositions associated with the displayed market lines. A particular proposition may indicate odds that market indicator **28** will be above or below a corresponding market line when a configurable time period **606** expires. In some embodiments, the indicated odds are fixed odds and the displayed market lines are constantly moving based at least in part on changing market conditions.

[0234] At step **704**, client **20** receives market line wager **602** associated with a displayed value of a particular market line. At step **706**, client **20** displays a plurality of reels **102**. In some embodiments, the perimeter of each reel **102** comprises a plurality of digits. Each reel **102** may correspond to a respective digit of the displayed value of the particular market line. At step **708**, client **20** receives a slot bet **22** associated with market line wager **602**. In some embodiments, in response to receiving the slot bet **22**, client **20** causes reels **102** to begin spinning. At step **710**, client **20** causes the displayed reels **102** to stop spinning such that each stopped reel **102** displays a respective digit. At step **712**, client **20** determines whether the number formed by the stopped reels **102** is higher or lower than the market line corresponding to market line wager **602**.

[0235] If client **20** determines at step **712** that the number formed by the stopped reels **102** is higher than the particular market line corresponding to market line wager **602**, then at step **714** client **20** determines whether market line wager **602** is that market indicator **28** will be higher or lower than the particular market line. If client **20** determines at step **714** that market line wager **602** is that market indicator **28** will be higher than the particular market line, then at step **716** client **20** may issue payout **72** for the winning slot bet **22**. If, however, client **20** determines at step **714** that market line wager **602** is that market indicator **28** will be lower than the particular market line, then at step **718** client **20** may display that the slot bet **22** is a losing bet **22**.

[0236] If client **20** determines at step **712** that the number formed by the stopped reels **102** is lower than the particular market line corresponding to market line wager **602**, then at step **720** client **20** determines whether market line wager **602** is that market indicator **28** will be higher or lower than the particular market line. If client **20** determines at step **720** that market line wager **602** is that market indicator **28** will be lower than the particular market line, then at step **716** client **20** may issue payout **72** for winning slot bet **22**. If, however, client **20** determines at step **720** that market line wager **602** is that market indicator **28** will be higher than the particular market line, then at step **718** client **20** may display that the slot bet **22** is a losing bet **22**. At step **722**, client **20** determines outcome of market line wager **602** based at least in part on the value of market indicator **28** when time period **606** expires. The method then ends.

[0237] Although embodiments of the invention and their advantages are described in detail, a person skilled in the art could make various alterations, additions, and omissions without departing from the spirit and scope of the present invention as defined by the appended claims.

[0238] Although some embodiments have been described with respect to slot machine implementations, it will be readily understood that other embodiments could include versions of any other game of skill and/or chance involving one or more players (e.g., card type games, roulette type games, games involving competition between multiple players, etc.)

[0239] Some aspects include a system comprising a memory having stored thereon a plurality of instructions configured to cause the system to cause a user interface to display a value of a first financial market indicator, receive a first stop command at a first time, in response to receiving the first stop command, determine a first element from the value of the first financial market indicator at the first time, determine a second element from a value of a second financial market indicator, and determine an outcome of a wager based at least in part on the determined first element and the

determined second element.

[0240] In some embodiments, the value of the first financial market indicator is displayed in association with a first stop control, and the first stop command is received in response to an actuation of the first stop control. In some embodiments, the plurality of instructions are further configured to cause the system to cause the user interface to display the value of the second financial market indicator and receive a second stop command at a second time. In some implementations, the determination of the second element is in response to receiving the second stop command; and the second element is determined from the value of the second financial market indicator at the second time. In some implementations, the value of the first financial market indicator is displayed in association with a first stop control, the first stop command is received in response to an actuation of the first stop control, the value of the second financial market indicator is displayed in association with a second stop control, and the second stop command is received in response to an actuation of the second stop control.

[0241] In some embodiments, the first financial market indicator is associated with at least one of: the Dow Jones Industrial Average, the NASDAQ, the Financial Times Stock Exchange, and the S&P 500. In some embodiments, the value of the first financial market indicator comprises a plurality of numerical digits, and determining the first element comprises identifying a digit from a predetermined decimal place of the displayed value of the first financial market indicator at the first time. In some embodiments, the wager identifies a wild element, and if the determined first element matches the wild element, then the determined first element is considered to match the determined second element.

[0242] In some embodiments, the plurality of instructions are further configured to cause the system to receive a surrender command prior to determining the outcome of the wager, and in response to receiving the surrender command, refund at least a portion of the wager. In some embodiments, the wager is a winning wager if the determined first element matches the determined second element. In some embodiments, the displayed value of the first financial market indicator is updated at a predetermined rate. In some embodiments, the plurality of instructions are further configured to cause the system to cause the user interface to display a spinning reel and stop the reel after receiving the first stop command. In some embodiments, the reel is caused to stop such that the second element is visible on the reel.

[0243] Some aspects include a method of wagering. In some embodiments, the method includes placing a wager on an electronic gaming machine and operating a first stop control at a first time to cause the electronic gaming machine to determine a first gaming element based on a value of a first financial market indicator associated with the first time, wherein the first element is used to determine at least part of an outcome of the wager.

[0244] In some embodiments, the electronic gaming machine includes a slot machine. In some embodiments, the electronic gaming machine is configured to display a value of the first market indicator that is updated at a predetermined rate. In some embodiments, the electronic gaming machine is further configured to display a value of a second market indicator that is updated at a predetermined rate, and wherein the method further comprises operating a second stop control at a second time to cause the electronic gaming machine to determine a second gaming element based on a value of a second market indicator associated with the second time, wherein the second element is used to determine at least part of the outcome of the wager. In some implementations, the wager is a winning wager if the determined first element matches the determined second element.

[0245] In some embodiments, the first financial market indicator is associated with at least one of the Dow Jones Industrial Average, the NASDAQ, the Financial Times Stock Exchange, and the S&P 500. In some embodiments, the value of the first financial market indicator comprises a plurality of numerical digits; and wherein determining the first gaming element comprises identifying a digit from a predetermined decimal place of the displayed value of the first financial

market indicator at the first time. In some embodiments, the wager identifies a wild element. Some embodiments further comprise entering a surrender command prior to an end of a wager event. In some embodiments, the wager involves the first market indicator and a second market indicator, and the wager is a winning wager if the determined first gaming element matches a determined second gaming element for the second market indicator.

[0246] Some aspects include a method of operating a gaming machine. In some embodiments, the method includes providing a representation of a market indicator and a possible future value of the market indicator associated with a future time, receiving a wager placed on the market indicator, the wager corresponding to a comparison between the possible value and the future value, and determining an outcome of the wager based on the possible future value and an actual value of the financial indicator at the future time.

[0247] Some embodiments further comprise determining an odds of the wager based at least in part on a distance of the future time from a time the wager is received. Some embodiments further comprise determining an odds of the wager based at least in part on a market trend associated with the market indicator. In some embodiments, the market indicator is associated with at least one of the Dow Jones Industrial Average, the NASDAQ, the Financial Times Stock Exchange, and the S&P 500.

[0248] In some embodiments, a distance between the market indicator and the possible future value decreases as a future time becomes closer to a current time. In some embodiments, the comparison identifies that the actual value of the market indicator will be at least one of equal to, greater than, and less than the future value at the future time. In some embodiments, the possible future value includes at least one of a first high line and a first low line. Some implementations further comprise providing a representation of a second possible future value associated with the future time, the second possible future value comprising at least one of a second low line and a second high line.

[0249] Some aspects includes a system comprising a memory having stored thereon a plurality of instructions configured to cause the system to receive a wager associated with a possible value of a market indicator at a future time, and allow a user to play a slot machine game that includes at least one reel, wherein, for each play of the slot machine game, the at least one reel displays at least one digit associated with an outcome of the slot machine game, and wherein the outcome is determined based at least in part on a comparison between the at least one digit and the possible value.

[0250] In some embodiments, the instructions are further configured to cause the system to, at the future time, compare a current value of the market indicator with the possible value to determine an outcome of the wager. In some embodiments, the instructions are further configured to cause the system to cause a user interface to display a plurality of wager propositions, wherein each wager proposition is associated with respective odds, and is associated with a respective possible value. In some implementations, the instructions are further configured to cause the system to adjust at least one of the respective odds and the respective possible value based on a market condition.

[0251] In some embodiments, the future value includes a plurality of digits, wherein the at least one reel includes a plurality of reels, and wherein the instructions are further configured to cause the system to cause a user interface to display the plurality of slot reels, wherein each slot reel corresponds to a respective one of the plurality of digits, and cause the plurality of slot reels to stop spinning so that the plurality of reels display a second plurality of digits. In some implementations, if the wager identifies that the market indicator will be greater than the possible value at the future time, then the slot machine game outcome is a winning bet if a second value corresponding the second plurality of digits is greater than the possible value, and if the wager identifies that the market indicator will be less than the possible value at the future time, then the slot machine game outcome is a winning bet if the second value is less than the possible value. In some implementations, the second value includes at least one of the sum of the second plurality of digits and a number defined digit-by-digit by the second plurality of digits. In some embodiments, the instructions are further configured to cause the system to receive a stop command and in response

to the stop command stop the at least one reel.

[0252] Some aspects include a method of playing a gaming device. In some embodiments, the method includes placing a wager on the gaming device, the wager being based, at least in part, on a possible future value of a market indicator, and operating the gaming device to play a slots game, wherein, at least one outcome of the slots game is based, at least in part, on an element of the wager.

[0253] In some embodiments, the wager indicates that a value of the market indicator will be at least one of equal to, greater than, and less than the possible future value at a future time. In some implementations, the element includes the possible future value. In some embodiments, the outcome of the slots game is based on a comparison of digits on a plurality of slot reels to digits of the possible future value.

Claims

1. A system comprising: a memory having stored thereon a plurality of instructions configured to cause the system to: receive a wager associated with a possible value of a market indicator at a future time; and allow a user to play a slot machine game that includes at least one reel, wherein, for each play of the slot machine game, the at least one reel displays at least one digit associated with an outcome of the slot machine game, and wherein the outcome is determined based at least in part on a comparison between the at least one digit and the possible value.
